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HEAT EXCHANGER UNIT

Abstract

A heat exchanger unit according to the present invention includes a sensible heat exchanger including a sensible heat exchange pipe disposed in a sensible heat exchange area for heating water used for heating by receiving sensible heat generated by a combustion reaction, wherein the sensible heat exchange pipe receives the water used for heating and flows same through the interior, and a sensible heat fin disposed in the sensible heat exchange area. The sensible heat fin is formed in a plate shape across the sensible heat exchange pipe and penetrated by the sensible heat exchange pipe; and a latent heat exchanger positioned downstream from the sensible heat exchange area on the basis of a reference direction, which is a flow direction of combustion gas generated during the combustion reaction, the latent heat exchanger including a latent heat exchange pipe disposed in a latent heat exchange area.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/099,223 filed on Jan. 19, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/973,025 filed on Dec. 7, 2020, and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,585,572 on Feb. 21, 2023 and entitled “HEAT EXCHANGER UNIT AND CONDENSING BOILER USING THE SAME,” which is the U.S. National Phase entry of International Patent Application No. PCT/KR2019/006543 filed May 30, 2019, which claims priority to Korean Patent Application Nos. 10-2018-0064669, filed on Jun. 5, 2018; 10-2018-0064666 filed Jun. 5, 2018; 10-2018-0064668 filed Jun. 5, 2018; and 10-2018-0156356 filed Dec. 6, 2018, all of the above listed applications are herein incorporated by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a heat exchanger unit used therein.

BACKGROUND ART

[0003] A boiler is an apparatus for heating a desired area by heating fluid in a container. Accordingly, to heat up heating-water of the boiler, the boiler generally has a heat source, a burner including the heat source, and a heat exchanger unit for heating the heating-water using combustion gas. In a condensing boiler that comprehensively uses heat of combustion gas, sensible heat generated from a burner is supplied to heating-water, and the sensible heat of the combustion gas generated from the burner and latent heat caused by a phase change of the combustion gas are supplied to the heating-water. Accordingly, the heating-water is heated.

[0004] To supply the sensible heat and the latent heat to the heating-water, a method of locating a container for storing the heating-water in a position close to an area in which the combustion gas flows and a heat source for supplying sensible heat is mainly used. Heat is indirectly transferred to the heating-water through the container to raise the temperature of the heating-water to a temperature appropriate for heating, and thereafter the heating-water is supplied to an area that has to be heated.

[0005] A plate type heat exchanger unit having a plurality of stacked plates is mainly used for the heat transfer. However, the plate type heat exchanger unit has problems of a difficulty in a manufacturing process and high cost despite excellent thermal efficiency.

DISCLOSURE

Technical Problem

[0006] The present disclosure has been made to solve the above-mentioned problems occurring in

the prior art. An aspect of the present disclosure provides a heat exchanger unit that has excellent thermal efficiency while using a fin-tube type heat exchange device.

Technical Solution

[0007] A heat exchanger unit according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes a sensible heat exchanging part including a sensible heat exchange pipe that is disposed in a sensible heat exchange area for receiving sensible heat generated by a combustion reaction and heating heating-water and that receives the heating-water and allows the heating-water to flow therethrough and a sensible heat fin disposed in the sensible heat exchange area and formed in a plate shape across the sensible heat exchange pipe such that the sensible heat exchange pipe passes through the sensible heat fin, and a latent heat exchanging part including a latent heat exchange pipe that is disposed in a latent heat exchange area for receiving latent heat generated during a phase change of combustion gas and heating the heating-water and that receives the heating-water and allows the heating-water to flow therethrough and a latent heat fin disposed in the latent heat exchange area and formed in a plate shape across the latent heat exchange pipe such that the latent heat exchange pipe passes through the latent heat fin, the latent heat exchange area being located downstream of the sensible heat exchange area based on a reference direction that is a flow direction of the combustion gas generated during the combustion reaction.

[0008] A condensing boiler according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes a burner assembly causes a combustion reaction, a combustion chamber located downstream of the burner assembly on the basis of a flow direction of a combustion gas generated by the combustion reaction, and in which flame generated by the combustion reaction is located and a heat exchanger unit configured to receive sensible heat and the combustion gas generated by the combustion reaction to heat heating-water. The heat exchanger unit includes a sensible heat exchanging part including a sensible heat exchange pipe disposed in a sensible heat exchange area and configured to receive the heating-water and allow the heating-water to flow therethrough and a sensible heat fin disposed in the sensible heat exchange area and formed in a plate shape across the sensible heat exchange pipe such that the sensible heat exchange pipe passes through the sensible heat fin, the sensible heat exchange area being configured to receive sensible heat generated by a combustion reaction and to heat the heating-water, the heat exchanger unit includes a latent heat exchanging part including a latent heat exchange pipe disposed in a latent heat exchange area and configured to receive the heating-water and allow the heating-water to flow therethrough and a latent heat fin disposed in the latent heat exchange area and formed in a plate shape across the latent heat exchange pipe such that the latent heat exchange pipe passes through the latent heat fin, the latent heat exchange area being located downstream of the sensible heat exchange area based on a reference direction that is a flow direction of combustion gas generated during the combustion reaction and configured to receive latent heat generated during a phase change of the combustion gas and to heat the heating-water.

Advantageous Effects

[0009] Accordingly, heat transfer efficiency may not be deteriorated despite the use of an inexpensive and easy-to-manufacture fin-tube type heat exchanger unit.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0010] FIG. 1 is a vertical sectional view of part of an exemplary heat exchanger unit.

[0011] FIG. 2 is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit and a condensing boiler using the same according to a first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0012] FIG. 3 is a side view of the heat exchanger unit and the condensing boiler using the same according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0013] FIG. **4** is a plan view of a combustion chamber of the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0014] FIG. **5** is a plan view of a sensible heat exchanger of the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0015] FIG. **6** is a view illustrating an area where a sensible heat exchange pipe and a sensible heat fin are disposed in the vertical sectional view of the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0016] FIG. **7** is a view illustrating an area where a sensible heat exchange pipe and a sensible heat fin are disposed in a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to one modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0017] FIG. **8** is a view illustrating a second general sensible heat side plate of the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure and flow passage caps included in a second flow passage cap plate when viewed from the outside along a predetermined direction.

[0018] FIG. **9** is a view illustrating a first general sensible heat side plate of the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure and flow passage caps included in a first flow passage cap plate when viewed from the inside along the predetermined direction.

[0019] FIG. **10** is a view illustrating a heat exchanger unit according to another modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure when viewed from outside a second connection flow passage cap plate.

[0020] FIG. **11** is a view illustrating a first connection flow passage cap plate of the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0021] FIG. **12** is a view illustrating a partial area of a second main general side plate of the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure together with flow passage caps included in the second connection flow passage cap plate when viewed from the outside along a predetermined direction.

[0022] FIG. **13** is a view illustrating a first main general side plate of the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure together with flow passage caps included in the first connection flow passage cap plate when viewed from the inside along a predetermined direction.

[0023] FIG. **14** is a perspective view illustrating a sensible heat flow passage and a latent heat flow passage of the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0024] FIG. **15** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to a second embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0025] FIG. **16** is a front view illustrating a flow passage cap plate of a heat exchanger unit according to a modified example of the second embodiment of the present disclosure together with pipes.

[0026] FIG. **17** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit and a condensing boiler using the same according to a third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0027] FIG. **18** is a side view of the heat exchanger unit and the condensing boiler using the same according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0028] FIG. **19** is a plan view of the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0029] FIG. **20** is a vertical sectional view of the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0030] FIG. **21** is a perspective view illustrating a plurality of downstream fins according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure and condensate located therebetween.

[0031] FIG. **22** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to a first modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0032] FIG. **23** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to a second modified

example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0033] FIG. **24** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to a third modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0034] FIG. **25** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to a fourth modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0035] FIG. **26** is a view illustrating a second general side plate of the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure together with flow passage caps included in the second flow passage cap plate.

[0036] FIG. **27** is a view illustrating a first general side plate of the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure together with flow passage caps included in the first flow passage cap plate.

[0037] FIG. **28** is a perspective view illustrating all flow passages included in the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0038] FIG. **29** is a perspective view illustrating a situation in which the connection flow passage cap plates are separated from each other in the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENT

[0039] Hereinafter, some embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the exemplary drawings. In adding the reference numerals to the components of each drawing, it should be noted that the identical or equivalent component is designated by the identical numeral even when they are displayed on other drawings. Further, in describing the embodiment of the present disclosure, a detailed description of well-known features or functions will be ruled out in order not to unnecessarily obscure the gist of the present disclosure.

[0040] In describing the components of the embodiment according to the present disclosure, terms such as first, second, “A”, “B”, (a), (b), and the like may be used. These terms are merely intended to distinguish one component from another component, and the terms do not limit the nature, sequence or order of the components. When a component is described as “connected”, “coupled”, or “linked” to another component, this may mean the components are not only directly “connected”, “coupled”, or “linked” but also are indirectly “connected”, “coupled”, or “linked” via a third component.

[0041] As a method of arranging a burner, heat exchangers, and a combustion chamber constituting a condensing boiler, a method of configuring the condensing boiler by locating the burner at the lowermost position and sequentially arranging the combustion chamber surrounded by insulation of a dry type, a sensible heat exchanger of a fin-tube type, and a latent heat exchanger of a plate type in an upward direction may be considered. This type of condensing boiler is referred to as a bottom-up boiler. In the case of the bottom-up boiler, condensate generated by condensation of combustion gas in the latent heat exchanger may fall onto the sensible heat exchanger and the combustion chamber. Therefore, the sensible heat exchanger and the insulation of the dry type that surrounds the combustion chamber may be easily corroded by the condensate with high acidity. Furthermore, as the different types of heat exchangers are connected with each other, manufacturing costs may be increased due to additional connecting parts.

[0042] To solve the problems caused by the condensate, a method of configuring a condensing boiler by locating a burner at the uppermost position and sequentially arranging a combustion chamber thermally insulated by being surrounded by a heat insulation pipe, a sensible heat exchanger of a fin-tube type, and a latent heat exchanger of a plate type in a downward direction may be considered. This type of condensing boiler is referred to as a top-down boiler. In this case, as the latent heat exchanger is located at the lowermost position, condensate is immediately discharged through a condensate receiver and does not reach the sensible heat exchanger or the combustion chamber, and thus a problem of corrosion may be solved. However, many parts including the heat insulation pipe used to cool the combustion chamber are used, and due to this,

the number of assembly steps is increased, which leads to an increase in manufacturing costs.

Furthermore, as the different types of heat exchangers are connected with each other, manufacturing costs may be increased due to additional connecting parts.

[0043] FIG. 1 is a vertical sectional view of part of an exemplary heat exchanger unit. As illustrated in FIG. 1, a top-down boiler may be used, and a method of performing thermal insulation in a dry type by surrounding a combustion chamber **102** and a sensible heat exchanger **103** with insulation **101** may be considered. That is, a case where the insulation of a dry type, which is used for the combustion chamber **102**, is disposed to insulate heat radiated from the area of the sensible heat exchanger **103** may be considered. However, in this case, due to the sensible heat exchanger **103**, flame generated through a combustion reaction, and excessive heat generated from combustion gas, the insulation **101** may be damaged, and the durability may be decreased. Furthermore, condensate is more likely to be generated in a position adjacent to the sensible heat exchanger **103** than in the combustion chamber **102**, and therefore when the insulation **101**, as in the drawing, further extends downward beyond the position that the combustion chamber **102** extends downward and reaches, the condensate may make contact with the insulation **101** of a dry type so that the insulation **101** may be damaged.

First Embodiment

[0044] FIG. 2 is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit and a condensing boiler **1** using the same according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. 3 is a side view of the heat exchanger unit and the condensing boiler **1** using the same according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0045] Referring to the drawings, the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure includes a sensible heat exchanger **30**, a latent heat exchanger **40**, and sensible heat insulation pipes **34**. The components constituting the heat exchanger unit may be fixed in positions as illustrated.

[0046] Furthermore, the condensing boiler **1** including the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure includes a combustion chamber **20** and a burner assembly **10** including a burner **11**. The burner assembly **10** and the heat exchanger unit are disposed in sequence along a flow direction **D1** of combustion gas, and components are arranged in the heat exchanger unit along the same direction in the order of the combustion chamber **20**, the sensible heat exchanger **30**, the latent heat exchanger **40**, and the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** disposed together with the sensible heat exchanger **30**. Accordingly, the components of the condensing boiler **1** will be described below in the above-described order of arrangement.

[0047] The heat exchanger unit and the condensing boiler **1** using the same according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure will be described below based on a top-down condensing boiler **1** in which combustion gas flows vertically downward. Accordingly, the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas that is represented by an arrow may be the same as the vertical downward direction at the position where the condensing boiler **1** is installed. As the top-down condensing boiler **1** is selected, condensate produced by condensation of the combustion gas may be generated only at the lowermost side of the condensing boiler **1** and may be immediately discharged to the outside through a lower end of the condensing boiler **1**. Accordingly, components constituting the condensing boiler **1** may be prevented from being corroded. However, the configuration of the present disclosure may be used for a bottom-up condensing boiler capable of naturally forming a path of heating-water in a downward direction by using a property by which heated combustion gas is moved upward by convection.

[0048] The condensing boiler **1** according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure may include a condensate receiver **55** located at the most downstream side along the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. When condensate generated from the latent heat exchanger **40** drops in the vertically downward direction by the weight of the condensate, the condensate receiver **55** may collect the condensate. To allow the collected condensate to be discharged through a condensate

outlet **53** extending in the vertically downward direction, the condensate receiver **55** may have an inner surface inclined toward the condensate outlet **53**.

[0049] Furthermore, to allow residual combustion gas to be discharged at the same time that the condensate is discharged, an exhaust duct **52** may be formed so as to be in communication with the condensate receiver **55**. The exhaust duct **52** extends in the vertically upward direction and discharges the residual combustion gas to the outside.

Burner Assembly **10**

[0050] The burner assembly **10** is a component that includes the burner **11** radiating heat and that causes a combustion reaction of injected fuel and air to generate combustion gas.

[0051] A premix burner may be used as the burner assembly **10** used in the condensing boiler **1** according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure. The premix type burner is a device that mixes injected air and fuel at a predetermined ratio and burns the mixed air and fuel using radiating heat to generate combustion gas. For this operation, the burner assembly **10** according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure may include a mix chamber **12** that is a space in which mixed fuel for a combustion reaction is prepared by mixing injected fuel and air at a predetermined ratio, and the burner **11** that applies heat to the mixed fuel mixed by the mix chamber **12**. The burner assembly **10** having the above-described structure is provided to obtain optimal fuel efficiency and thermal efficiency by causing a combustion reaction by heating air and fuel mixed at a ratio appropriate for the combustion reaction.

[0052] To supply air into the mix chamber **12** and blow combustion gas generated in the burner assembly **10** in the vertically downward direction, the condensing boiler **1** of the present disclosure may further include a blower **54**. The blower **54** may include a pump that is connected with the mix chamber **12** and that forcibly delivers air toward the burner assembly **10** that is connected to the mix chamber **12** in the vertically downward direction.

Combustion Chamber **20**

[0053] FIG. **4** is a plan view of the combustion chamber **20** according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0054] The combustion chamber **20** will be described below with reference to FIG. **4** together with FIGS. **2** and **3**. The combustion chamber **20** is a component that includes an interior space **22** provided such that flame that a combustion reaction by the burner assembly **10** generates is located. Accordingly, the combustion chamber **20** is formed by surrounding the interior space **22** with sidewalls. The burner assembly **10** and the combustion chamber **20** are coupled such that the burner **11** of the burner assembly **10** is located upstream of the interior space **22** based on the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas.

[0055] The burner assembly **10** applies heat to air and fuel to cause a combustion reaction. Flame and combustion gas accompanied by thermal energy are generated as products of the combustion reaction. The flame is located in the interior space **22** of the combustion chamber **20**, but extends from the burner assembly **10** along the flow direction **D** of the combustion gas. The combustion gas flows through the interior space **22**. The interior space **22** of the combustion chamber **20** may be connected in a direction parallel to the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. In the first embodiment of the present disclosure, the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas is the vertically downward direction, and therefore the interior space **22** of the combustion chamber **20** is formed to be connected in the vertical direction.

[0056] A combustion chamber heat insulation part **24** may be formed on at least a partial area of an inner surface of a combustion chamber sidewall **21** constituting the combustion chamber **20**. The combustion chamber sidewall **21** may be constituted by two general side plates **211** parallel to each other and two heat insulation side plates **212** perpendicular to the general side plates **211** and parallel to each other and may be formed in a rectangular parallelepiped shape. The combustion chamber heat insulation part **24** may be disposed on the insides of the heat insulation side plates **212**. The combustion chamber heat insulation part **24** may be formed of insulation blocking a heat

flow and may reduce the amount by which heat generated by the combustion reaction is transferred outside the combustion chamber **20** through inner surfaces of the combustion chamber **20**. The amount of heat transferred from the interior space **22** of the combustion chamber **20** to the outside of the combustion chamber **20** may be reduced by the combustion chamber heat insulation part **24**. A porous polystyrene panel decreasing a heat flow or a needle mat made of silica, which is an inorganic material, may be used as an example of the insulation. However, the type of the insulation is not limited thereto.

[0057] The combustion chamber heat insulation part **24** may be disposed on the general side plates **211** of the combustion chamber **20** as well, and thus an additional thermal insulation effect may be obtained by surrounding the entire interior space **22** of the combustion chamber **20** with the insulation.

[0058] A heat insulation pipe through which fluid flows may be disposed around the combustion chamber **20** for thermal insulation. However, in a case where a large number of heat insulation pipes are used, a lot of cost is consumed in production. However, because the heat exchanger unit of the present disclosure is implemented in the top-down type, condensation of condensate does not occur in the combustion chamber **20**, and there is no risk of corrosion. Accordingly, the combustion chamber **20** of a dry type that uses insulation cheaper than a heat insulation pipe as a material of which the combustion chamber heat insulation part **24** is made may be configured.

[0059] The length of the combustion chamber heat insulation part **24** may be determined such that the combustion chamber heat insulation part **24** surrounds only the interior space **22** of the combustion chamber **20** without surrounding the sensible heat exchanger **30**, which will be described below, based on the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. That is, the combustion chamber heat insulation part **24** may be provided so as not to be located inside a sensible heat exchanger case **31** that will be described below. Accordingly, in the case where the insulation **101** is disposed as illustrated in FIG. 1, the insulation **101** may be damaged by excessive heat and condensate, whereas in the first embodiment of the present disclosure, the combustion chamber heat insulation part **24** is disposed as illustrated in FIG. 2, and thus excessive heat generated from the sensible heat exchanger **30** may not be transferred to the combustion chamber heat insulation part **24**.

Sensible Heat Exchanger **30**

[0060] FIG. 5 is a plan view of the sensible heat exchanger **30** of the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. 6 is a view illustrating an area where a sensible heat exchange pipe **32** and a sensible heat fin **33** are disposed in the vertical sectional view of the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0061] A basic configuration of the sensible heat exchanger **30** will be described below with reference to FIGS. 2, 3, 5, and 6.

[0062] The sensible heat exchanger **30** is disposed downstream of the combustion chamber **20** based on the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. The sensible heat exchanger **30** is a component that receives, by radiant heat and convection of the combustion gas, sensible heat generated by a combustion reaction triggered by the burner assembly **10** located over the sensible heat exchanger **30** and that heats heating-water flowing in the sensible heat exchanger **30**.

[0063] Specifically, the sensible heat exchanger **30** includes the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** through which the heating-water flows and around which the combustion gas flows, and the sensible heat exchanger case **31** into which opposite ends of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** are inserted. The sensible heat exchange pipe **32** is located in the sensible heat exchanger case **31**, and the combustion gas flows around the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** to indirectly exchange heat with the heating-water.

[0064] The sensible heat exchange pipe **32** extends along a predetermined direction **D2** in a space formed in the sensible heat exchanger case **31**. The predetermined direction **D2** may preferably be a direction perpendicular to the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. The sensible heat exchange

pipe **32** may include a plurality of straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** arranged to be spaced apart from each other along an orthogonal direction perpendicular to the one direction and the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas.

[0065] The plurality of straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** are arranged, and flow passage cap plates **361** and **362** that will be described below exist to connect end portions of the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** inserted into insertion holes formed in general sensible heat side plates **311** of the sensible heat exchanger case **31** that will be described below. The set of the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** forms the one sensible heat exchange pipe **32**.

Accordingly, a continuous winding flow passage of the heating-water may be formed by the arrangement of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**.

[0066] For example, in a case where the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** of FIG. 5 are connected in series, the heating-water may be heated by receiving sensible heat of the combustion gas and the burner assembly **10** while passing through the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** in such a manner that the heating-water introduced in the direction of the arrow illustrated in FIG. 5 is discharged by flowing to the right in the drawing along the first outer straight portion **321** included in the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, flowing to the left in the drawing along the intermediate straight portion **323** located under the first outer straight portion **321** in the drawing, flowing, in a discharge step, to the right in the drawing along the intermediate straight portion **324** located over the second outer straight portion **322** in the drawing, and moving to the left in the drawing along the second outer straight portion **322**.

[0067] A turbulator (not illustrated) having a shape that hampers a flow of the heating-water to make the flow of the heating-water turbulent may be disposed in the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**.

[0068] The sensible heat exchanger case **31** may be constituted by two general side plate portions spaced apart from each other in the predetermined direction **D2** and parallel to each other and two heat insulation side plate portions spaced apart from each other along an orthogonal direction perpendicular to the predetermined direction **D2** and parallel to each other and may be formed in the form of a rectangular parallelepiped. The general side plate portions and the heat insulation side plate portions may be general side plates and heat insulation side plates that are separate from each other and may be partial areas of a side plate of an integrated heat exchanger case. In this disclosure, it will be exemplified that the general side plate portions and the heat insulation side plate portions are formed of general side plates and heat insulation side plates that are separate from each other.

[0069] The general sensible heat side plates **311** and sensible heat insulation side plates **312** form the interior space of the sensible heat exchanger case **31**. Here, the sensible heat insulation side plates **312** are used with the meaning of side plates to which the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are disposed to be adjacent, rather than the meaning of side plates that reduce the amount of heat transferred to the outside, thereby achieving thermal insulation.

[0070] The general sensible heat side plates **311** may include a first general sensible heat side plate **3111** and a second general sensible heat side plate **3112** spaced apart from each other along the predetermined direction **D2**. The opposite ends of the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** constituting the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** may be inserted into the first general sensible heat side plate **3111** and the second general sensible heat side plate **3112**, and thus the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** may be accommodated in the sensible heat exchanger case **31**. The combustion gas flows in the space formed in the sensible heat exchanger case **31** and moves from the combustion chamber **20** to a latent heat exchanger case **41** that will be described below.

[0071] The sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be disposed adjacent to the sensible heat exchanger **30**. The sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are pipe type components that are disposed to thermally insulate the sensible heat exchanger **30** by allowing the heating-water to flow through the components. Here, the thermal insulation includes both confining heat in any position to prevent

heat transfer and absorbing heat released from any position to the outside so as to decrease the amount of heat finally released to the outside. The meaning of the thermal insulation may be identically applied to other embodiments of the present disclosure and modified examples thereof. [0072] Specifically, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be disposed adjacent to the outsides of the sensible heat insulation side plates **312**. The sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be disposed adjacent to the two sensible heat insulation side plates **312**, respectively. The sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be disposed to make contact with the outsides of the sensible heat insulation side plates **312**, or the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be disposed in positions spaced apart from the outsides of the sensible heat insulation side plates **312**.

[0073] Referring to the drawings, in the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure, a first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** and a second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** are spaced apart from each other and are disposed along the outsides of the sensible heat insulation side plates **312**. In FIG. 5, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are illustrated as being located inward of the sensible heat insulation side plates **312**. However, the sensible heat insulation side plates **312** cover the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** at the same time as being located inward of the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** inside the sensible heat exchanger **30**, and the positions of the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are illustrated for convenience of description. Accordingly, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** covered by the sensible heat insulation side plates **312** are actually located in the area where the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are illustrated in FIG. 5, and in the plan view, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** do not appear.

[0074] Accordingly, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are located outside the sensible heat exchanger case **31** through which the combustion gas passes, and therefore the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may not cross or meet the combustion gas. The sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may not be used for heat exchange between the combustion gas and the heating-water, but may perform only a thermal insulation function of blocking release of heat from the sensible heat exchanger **30** to the outside by using the heating-water.

[0075] The sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be disposed to be spaced apart from the combustion chamber **20** along the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas without making contact with the combustion chamber **20**. Accordingly, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may not be used for thermal insulation of the combustion chamber **20**, but may be used only for thermal insulation of the sensible heat exchanger **30**.

[0076] The sensible heat insulation pipes **34**, together with the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, form a sensible heat flow passage through which the heating-water flows.

[0077] The shape of interior spaces of the sensible heat insulation pipes **34**, as illustrated in FIGS. 2 and 6, may be formed in an oval shape in a cross-section obtained by cutting the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** with a plane perpendicular to the direction in which the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** extend. Specifically, the interior spaces of the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be formed in an oval shape having a long axis parallel to the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas.

[0078] The sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be located adjacent to the sensible heat insulation side plates **312** of the sensible heat exchanger **30** and may be disposed at an upstream side based on the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. That is, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be disposed closer to the combustion chamber **20** than the latent heat exchanger **40** that will be described below. Flame generated by the burner assembly **20** in the combustion chamber **20** may reach downstream of the combustion chamber **20** based on the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas, and therefore the upstream side of the sensible heat exchanger **30** may have a highest temperature while making contact with the combustion chamber **20**. Accordingly, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may be disposed adjacent to the upstream side of the sensible heat exchanger **30** and may thermally insulate the upstream side of the sensible heat exchanger **30** from which a large amount of heat is released due to the largest temperature difference between the interior space of the sensible heat exchanger **30** and the outside. However, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may

be located in the center based on the flow direction D1 of the combustion gas.

[0079] The sensible heat exchanger **30** may further include the sensible heat fin **33** capable of raising the thermal conductivity of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, and thus the sensible heat exchanger **30** of a fin-tube type may be formed. The sensible heat fin **33** is formed in a plate shape that is perpendicular to the direction in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** extends, and the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** passes through the sensible heat fin **33**. A plurality of sensible heat fins **33** may be disposed to be spaced apart from each other at predetermined intervals along the predetermined direction D2 in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** extends. The sensible heat exchange pipe **32** and the sensible heat fin **33** may be formed of a metallic material with high thermal conductivity to increase the surface area of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** from which the sensible heat fin **33** receives sensible heat, thereby transferring a larger amount of sensible heat to the heating-water.

[0080] In a cross-section obtained by cutting the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** with a plane perpendicular to the predetermined direction D2 in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** extends, the interior space of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** may be formed in the shape of a long hole that extends along the flow direction D1 of the combustion gas. As can be seen in FIG. 6, the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure may have a flat long hole shape formed such that a value obtained by dividing the length of the interior space of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** in the cross-section based on the flow direction D1 of the combustion gas by the width according to the direction perpendicular to the flow direction D1 of the combustion gas equals 2 or more.

[0081] When the flat type pipe having the above-described shape is employed for the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, due to a wider heat exchange area in the relationship with combustion gas, the heating-water may receive a larger amount of heat and may be sufficiently heated even though flowing along the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** having the same length, as compared with when a pipe having a different shape, such as a circular shape or an oval shape, is employed for the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**.

[0082] A through-hole through which the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** passes may be formed in the sensible heat fin **33**. The area of the through-hole may be equal to or smaller than the area of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, and the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** may be firmly inserted into the through-hole. Furthermore, the sensible heat fin **33** may be integrally coupled with the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** through brazing welding.

[0083] However, the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are not coupled with the sensible heat fin **33**. The sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are not fastened with the sensible heat fin **33**, and the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** and the sensible heat fin **33** may be disposed on opposite sides with the sensible heat insulation side plates **312** therebetween. The sensible heat fin **33** and the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** may make contact with the sensible heat insulation side plates **312**, but the sensible heat fin **33** and the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** do not make direct contact with each other. Because the sensible heat insulation pipes **34**, as described above, are disposed for thermal insulation of the sensible heat exchanger **30** rather than for heat exchange between the combustion gas and the heating-water, the sensible heat fin **33** and the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are not directly connected with each other. Accordingly, the sensible heat fin **33** and the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are disposed so as not to cross each other.

[0084] A common louver hole **331** may be additionally formed in the sensible heat fin **33** along the predetermined direction D2 in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** extends. The louver hole **331** may be formed by punching. The louver hole **331** includes a burr raised along the periphery thereof. When the combustion gas flows, the burr blocks the combustion gas to cause the combustion gas to flow around the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, thereby facilitating heat exchange between the combustion gas and the heating-water.

[0085] A plurality of louver holes **331** may be formed. The louver holes **331**, as illustrated in FIG.

6, may include a plurality of first louver holes **3311** that extend in an oblique direction with respect to the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas and that are formed in the outermost portions of the sensible heat fin **33**, and a plurality of second louver holes **3312** that are formed between the sensible heat exchange pipes **32** adjacent to each other and that extend in the direction perpendicular to the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. The louver holes **331** may be disposed to be spaced apart from each other at predetermined intervals along the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas.

[0086] The sensible heat fin **33** may further include valleys **334** and protruding portions **333**. The sensible heat fin **33** may be basically formed to surround the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**. The sensible heat fin **33** may surround areas corresponding to a predetermined width from the peripheries of upstream-side end portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** based on the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas such that the areas are distinguished from the remaining areas of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**. Accordingly, between the adjacent upstream-side end portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, the valleys **334** may be concavely formed in the sensible heat fin **33** along the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. The areas of the sensible heat fin **33** that are adjacent to the upstream-side end portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** relatively protrude to form the protruding portions **333**. Unnecessary areas are open by forming the valleys **334**, and thus the combustion gas may more freely flow between the sensible heat fin **33** and the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**.

[0087] The sensible heat fin **33** may further include concave portions **332**. The concave portions **332** are concavely formed from a downstream-side edge of the sensible heat fin **33** toward downstream-side end portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** based on the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. The purpose of forming the concave portions **332** is similar to the purpose of forming the valleys **334**.

[0088] According to one modified example of the first embodiment, the shapes of a sensible heat exchange pipe **62**, sensible heat insulation pipes **64**, and a sensible heat fin **63** may be deformed. FIG. 7 is a view illustrating an area where the sensible heat exchange pipe **62** and the sensible heat fin **63** are disposed in a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to the one modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0089] According to the one modified example of the first embodiment, the sensible heat insulation pipes **64** may be disposed adjacent to an upstream side of a sensible heat exchanger **60** based on the flow direction of the combustion gas, which is one of directions in which the cross-section of the illustrated sensible heat exchange pipe **62** extends, and a cross-section obtained by cutting the sensible heat insulation pipes **64** with a plane perpendicular to a predetermined direction in which the sensible heat insulation pipes **64** extend may have a circular shape. Furthermore, unlike in FIG. 6, the sensible heat insulation pipes **64** may be disposed adjacent to an inner surface of a heat insulation side plate **65**. Unlike in the first embodiment of FIG. 6, six sensible heat exchange pipes **62** may be provided in the one modified example of the first embodiment of FIG. 7. However, the number of sensible heat exchange pipes **62** is not limited thereto.

[0090] According to the one modified example of the first embodiment, likewise to second louver holes **6312**, first louver holes **6311** of the sensible heat fin **63** may extend in a direction perpendicular to the flow direction of the combustion gas. Various modifications can be made to the shape of louver holes **631**.

[0091] The flow passage cap plates **361** and **362** of the sensible heat exchanger **30** according to the first embodiment will be described below with reference to FIGS. 2, 3, 5, 6, 8, and 9. FIG. 8 is a view illustrating the second general sensible heat side plate **3112** according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure and flow passage caps included in the second flow passage cap plate **362** when viewed from the outside along the predetermined direction **D2**. FIG. 9 is a view illustrating the first general sensible heat side plate **3111** of the heat exchanger unit according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure and flow passage caps included in the first flow passage cap

plate **361** when viewed from the inside along the predetermined direction **D2**.

[0092] Referring to FIG. **29** for explaining another modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure, FIG. **8** is view in which flow passage caps **3621**, **3622**, and **3623** of the second flow passage cap plate **362** are illustrated by dotted lines on a view of the second general sensible heat side plate **3112**, the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, and the sensible heat insulation pipes **341** and **342** of the first embodiment of the present disclosure that corresponds to a view of a second main general side plate **5112** and pipes **32**, **42**, **341**, and **342** coupled thereto when viewed from a second connection flow passage cap plate **72** of FIG. **29** along line H-H'. FIG. **9** is a view in which flow passage caps **3611** and **3612** of the first flow passage cap plate **361** are illustrated by dotted lines on a view of the first general sensible heat side plate **3111**, the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, and the sensible heat insulation pipes **341** and **342** of the first embodiment of the present disclosure that corresponds to a view of a first main general side plate **5111**, into which a first connection flow passage cap plate **71** is inserted, when viewed along line G-G' of FIG. **29** for explaining the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0093] The heat exchanger unit may include the plurality of flow passage cap plates **361** and **362** including a plurality of flow passage caps that connect the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** and end portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** adjacent to the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** or connect the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** adjacent to each other among the plurality of straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324**. The flow passage cap plates **361** and **362** may include the flow passage caps and may connect the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** spaced apart from each other, thereby forming a flow passage through which the heating-water flows in the sensible heat exchanger **30**.

[0094] Specifically, opposite ends of the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** included in the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** and opposite ends of the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are inserted into the general sensible heat side plates **311** of the sensible heat exchanger case **31**, but are open without being closed. The straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** included in the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** and the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** extend from one of the general sensible heat side plates **311** to the other, and the opposite ends thereof are exposed outside the general sensible heat side plates **311**. The flow passage cap plates **361** and **362** are coupled to the general sensible heat side plates **311** while covering the general sensible heat side plates **311** from the outside. Accordingly, the flow passage caps of the flow passage cap plates **361** and **362**, together with the general sensible heat side plates **311**, form a connection space that surrounds the ends of the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** and the ends of the sensible heat insulation pipes **34**.

[0095] The flow passage caps included in the flow passage cap plates **361** and **362** form an empty connection space, in which fluid is able to flow, between the general sensible heat side plates **311** and the inner surfaces of the flow passage caps. The flow passage caps having the connection space therein may connect two straight portions adjacent to each other among the plurality of straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** inserted into the general sensible heat side plates **311**, or may connect the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** and straight portions adjacent to the sensible heat insulation pipes **34**. The flow passage cap plates **361** and **362** may be coupled to the general sensible heat side plates **311** through brazing welding, or may be fit into the general sensible heat side plates **311**. However, the coupling method is not limited thereto.

[0096] The number of straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** or the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** that the flow passage caps simultaneously connect is not limited to the content illustrated in the drawing. Accordingly, the number of flow passage caps included in one flow passage cap plate **361** or **362** is also not limited to the content illustrated, and a modification can be made to the number of flow passage caps.

[0097] A flow passage cap may form a series flow passage in which an inlet of one pipe and an

outlet of another pipe are connected, or may form a parallel flow passage in which inlets and outlets of connected pipes are common. Here, an inlet refers to an opening at one end of a pipe through which the heating-water is introduced into the pipe, and an outlet refers to an opening at an opposite end of the pipe through which the heating-water is released from the pipe. The pipes include the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** and the first and second sensible heat insulation pipes **341** and **342**. In a case of forming a series flow passage using the pipes, acoustic boiling noise generated by the heating-water that flows slow and is overheated may be reduced, and the heating-water may be allowed to flow fast. In a case where a parallel flow passage is at least partially included in the series flow passage, the load of a pump forcibly delivering the heating-water may be decreased.

[0098] A straight portion in which one end of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** is located and that is located at the outermost position based on the orthogonal direction is referred to as the first outer straight portion **321**. A sensible heat insulation pipe adjacent to the first outer straight portion **321** is referred to as the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341**.

[0099] Furthermore, a sensible heat insulation pipe located on the opposite side to the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** in the orthogonal direction is referred to as the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342**, a straight portion adjacent to the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** is referred to as the second outer straight portion **322**, and straight portions located between the first outer straight portion **321** and the second outer straight portion **322** are referred to as the intermediate straight portions **323** and **324**.

[0100] The first sensible heat insulation pipe **341**, the first outer straight portion **321**, the intermediate straight portions **323** and **324**, the second outer straight portion **322**, and the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** may be sequentially connected to form one series sensible heat flow passage, or may form a parallel flow passage in which inlets and outlets of at least some thereof are common. One intermediate straight portion **323** and the other intermediate straight portion **324** may also be connected in series.

[0101] The pipes may be connected only in series to form a sensible heat flow passage. For example, inlets and outlets of pipes adjacent to each other among the pipes may be connected in series to form a sensible heat flow passage through which the heating-water is delivered from the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** to the first outer straight portion **321**, the intermediate straight portion **323** adjacent to the first outer straight portion **321**, the intermediate straight portion **324** adjacent to the second outer straight portion **322**, the second outer straight portion **322**, and the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** in sequence. A sensible heat flow passage configured only in series will be described below in detail in the description of a sensible heat flow passage included in a heat exchanger unit according to another modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure that will be described with reference to FIGS. **10** to **14**.

[0102] A sensible heat flow passage may partly include a parallel flow passage, and therefore a case where some of the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** are connected in parallel will be described in the description of a sensible heat flow passage according to an embodiment of the present disclosure that is described with reference to FIGS. **8** and **9**.

[0103] For example, a parallel flow passage may be configured as follows. The first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** and the first outer straight portion **321** may form a parallel flow passage, the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** and the second outer straight portion **322** may form a parallel flow passage, the intermediate straight portions **323** and **324** may form a parallel flow passage, the first outer straight portion **321** and the intermediate straight portion **323** may form a parallel flow passage, and the second outer straight portion **322** and the intermediate straight portion **324** may form a parallel flow passage.

[0104] Furthermore, an entire sensible heat flow passage may be configured by combining a plurality of parallel flow passages among the parallel flow passages with a series flow passage. For example, when the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** and the first outer straight portion **321**

form a parallel flow passage, the parallel flow passage, the intermediate straight portions **323** and **324**, the second outer straight portion **322**, and the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** may be sequentially connected to form one sensible heat flow passage. In contrast, when the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** and the second outer straight portion **322** form a parallel flow passage, the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341**, the first outer straight portion **321**, the intermediate straight portions **323** and **324**, and the parallel flow passage may be sequentially connected to form one sensible heat flow passage. Furthermore, in a case where parallel flow passages are formed in the above-described two portions, the parallel flow passages may be connected with the intermediate straight portions **323** and **324** located therebetween to form one sensible heat flow passage.

[0105] A case where a parallel flow passage receives the heating-water first when the heating-water is introduced into the sensible heat exchanger **30** will be described in the first embodiment of the present disclosure. The first outer straight portion **321** and the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** may be connected in parallel and may receive and discharge the heating-water together. A heating-water supply hole **371** may be formed in the inlet flow passage cap **3621** among the flow caps included in the second flow passage cap plate **362** that covers the second general sensible heat side plate **3112**. The heating-water supply hole **371** may be an opening that receives the heating-water from a heating-water pipe and delivers the heating-water to the inlet flow passage cap **3621**. The heating-water supply hole **371** may connect a sensible heat flow passage and a latent heat flow passage by receiving the heating-water discharged from the latent heat exchanger **40**.

[0106] The inlet flow passage cap **3621** connects one end of the first outer straight portion **321** and one end of the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** that is adjacent to the one end of the first outer straight portion **321**. While the heating-water is supplied to the inlet flow passage cap **3621** through the heating-water supply hole **371**, the heating-water is introduced into the one end of the first outer straight portion **321** and the one end of the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** that are connected to the inlet flow passage cap **3621**.

[0107] The heating-water passes through the first outer straight portion **321** and the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** and reaches the first flow passage cap **3611** of the first flow passage cap plate **361** located on the opposite side to the second flow passage cap plate **362** based on the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**. The first flow passage cap **3611** connects an opposite end of the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341**, an opposite end of the first outer straight portion **321**, and the intermediate straight portion **323** adjacent to the first outer straight portion **321**. Accordingly, the first outer straight portion **321** and the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** is connected with the adjacent intermediate straight portion **323** in series in the first flow passage cap **3611** and receives the heating-water passing through the first outer straight portion **321** and the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341**.

[0108] The intermediate straight portion **323** adjacent to the first outer straight portion **321** and the intermediate straight portion **324** adjacent to the second outer straight portion **322** that will be described below may be connected in the intermediate flow passage cap **3623** located on the second flow passage cap plate **362** and may deliver the heating-water from one intermediate straight portion **323** to the other intermediate straight portion **324**. The two intermediate straight portions **323** and **324** form part of a heating-water flow passage in series in the intermediate flow passage cap **3623**.

[0109] A case where the heating-water is discharged through a parallel flow passage from the sensible heat exchanger **30** will be described. A straight portion disposed adjacent to the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342**, which is the sensible heat insulation pipe **34** through which the heating-water is discharged, is the second outer straight portion **322**.

[0110] The second outer straight portion **322** and the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** may be connected in parallel and may receive and discharge the heating-water together. One end of the second outer straight portion **322** and one end of the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** that is

adjacent to the one end of the second outer straight portion **322** are connected with the straight portion **324** adjacent to the second outer straight portion **322** in series in the second flow passage cap **3621** among the flow passage caps included in the first flow passage cap plate **361** that covers the first general sensible heat side plate **3111**. Accordingly, the heating-water delivered to the second flow passage cap **3612** through the adjacent straight portion **324** is introduced into the one end of the second outer straight portion **322** and the one end of the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342**.

[0111] The heating-water passes through the second outer straight portion **322** and the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** and is discharged to an opposite end of the second outer straight portion **322** and an opposite end of the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342**. The opposite end of the second outer straight portion **322** and the opposite end of the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** are connected to the outlet flow passage cap **3622**, which is one of the flow passage caps formed on the second flow passage cap plate **362**, and therefore the heating-water is located in the outlet flow passage cap **3622**. The outlet flow passage cap **3622** includes a heating-water outlet **372**, and the heating-water released to the outlet flow passage cap **3622** is discharged through the heating-water outlet **372**. The heating-water pipe may receive the heated heating-water through the heating-water outlet **372** and may deliver the heating-water to a main flow passage.

[0112] The description of the configuration of the sensible heat flow passage of the first embodiment may be applied to other embodiments of the present disclosure and modified examples thereof.

Latent Heat Exchanger **40**

[0113] The latent heat exchanger **40** will be described below with reference to FIGS. **2** and **3**. The latent heat exchanger **40** may be disposed downstream of the sensible heat exchanger **30** based on the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. The latent heat exchanger **40** receives latent heat generated during a phase change of the combustion gas and heats the heating-water using the latent heat. Accordingly, the combustion gas passing through the sensible heat exchanger **30** is delivered to the latent heat exchanger **40**, the heating-water flows in the latent heat exchanger **40**, and the heating-water and the combustion gas indirectly exchange heat with each other.

[0114] Similarly to the sensible heat exchanger **30**, the latent heat exchanger **40** may include a latent heat exchange pipe **42** through which the heating-water flows and around which the combustion gas flows. The latent heat exchange pipe **42** may deliver latent heat by a phase change of the combustion gas to the heating-water. The latent heat exchanger **40** may include the latent heat exchanger case **41** into which opposite ends of the latent heat exchange pipe **42** are inserted. The latent heat exchange pipe **42** may be formed to be similar to the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, and the latent heat exchanger case may also be formed to be similar to the sensible heat exchanger case **31**. Therefore, exceptional characteristics will be described below, but the overall description is replaced with the description of the sensible heat exchanger **30**. However, a phenomenon may arise in which condensate is generated by a phase change of the combustion gas around the latent heat exchange pipe **42** and falls into the condensate receiver **55** by the gravity.

[0115] Likewise to the sensible heat exchanger **30**, the latent heat exchanger **40** may be of a fin-tube type. Accordingly, a latent heat fin **43** is formed in a plate shape perpendicular to the predetermined direction **D2** in which the latent heat exchange pipe **42** extends, and the latent heat exchange pipe **42** passes through the latent heat fin **43**. The latent heat fin **43** may transfer a larger amount of latent heat to the heating-water by increasing the surface area of the latent heat exchange pipe **42** capable of receiving latent heat.

[0116] A plurality of latent heat fins **43** may be disposed to be spaced apart from each other at predetermined intervals along the predetermined direction **D2** in which the latent heat exchange pipe **42** extends. The intervals at which the latent heat fins **43** are spaced apart from each other may be intervals by which condensate formed between the adjacent latent heat fins **43** is easily discharged. The intervals by which the condensate is easily discharged refer to intervals between

the latent heat fins **43** in a state in which the weight of the condensate formed between the latent heat fins **43** is greater than the vertical resultant force of tensions acting between the latent heat fins **43** and the condensate. The height of the condensate formed between the latent heat fins **43** is inversely proportional to the minimum interval between the latent heat fins **43** by which the condensate is easily discharged. Therefore, the intervals by which the condensate is easily discharged may be determined by selecting an appropriate height of the condensate desired to be discharged from the latent heat exchanger **40**.

[0117] The number of latent heat fins **43** may be smaller than the number of sensible heat fins **33**. Accordingly, the intervals at which the adjacent latent heat fins **43** are spaced apart from each other may be greater than or equal to the intervals at which the adjacent sensible heat fins **33** are spaced apart from each other. Specific descriptions of the numbers and intervals of the sensible heat fins **33** and the latent heat fins **43** are replaced with contents that will be described below in a third embodiment. The cross-sectional area of the interior space of the latent heat exchange pipe **42** obtained by cutting the latent heat exchange pipe **42** with a plane perpendicular to the direction in which the latent heat exchange pipe **42** extends may be smaller than the cross-sectional area of the interior space of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** obtained by cutting the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** with a plane perpendicular to the direction in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** extends. The direction in which the latent heat exchange pipe **42** extends may also be the predetermined direction D2. As in the description of the latent heat fin **43** described above, by making the size of the latent heat exchange pipe **42** smaller than the size of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, the latent heat exchange pipe **42** may have a larger surface area in the same volume than the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**. As the surface area of the latent heat exchange pipe **42** is increased, a larger amount of heat may be exchanged between the heating-water flowing along the latent heat exchange pipe **42** and the condensate.

[0118] The cross-section of the latent heat exchange pipe **42** obtained by cutting the latent heat exchange pipe **42** with a plane perpendicular to the predetermined direction D2 may have a long hole shape similarly to the cross-section of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**.

[0119] In the first embodiment of the present disclosure, the latent heat exchanger **40** is illustrated as having no means for thermal insulation. However, in various modified examples, the latent heat exchanger **40** may also have latent heat insulation pipes (not illustrated) that are disposed in the same manner as the sensible heat insulation pipes **34**. The latent heat insulation pipes may be disposed adjacent to the latent heat exchanger case, and the heating-water may flow through the latent heat insulation pipes to thermally insulate the latent heat exchanger **40**.

[0120] Although the sensible heat exchanger case **31** and the latent heat exchanger case **41** have been described as separate from each other, the sensible heat exchanger case **31** and the latent heat exchanger case **41** may be integrally formed with each other as illustrated in the drawing. In this case, an integrated main case **51** including both the sensible heat exchanger case **31** and the latent heat exchanger case **41** may be considered. Accordingly, the sensible heat insulation side plates **312** of the sensible heat exchanger **30** and latent heat insulation side plates **412** of the latent heat exchanger **40** may integrally form main heat insulation side plates **512**, and the general sensible heat side plates **311** of the sensible heat exchanger **30** and general latent heat side plates **411** of the latent heat exchanger **40** may integrally form main general latent heat side plates **511**. Likewise, a first main general side plate **5111** included in the main general side plates **511** may include the first sensible heat insulation side plate **3111** and a first latent heat insulation side plate **4111** located at the same side along the predetermined direction D2, and a second main general side plate **5112** included in the main general side plates **511** may include the second sensible heat insulation side plate **3112** and a second latent heat insulation side plate **4112** located on the opposite side along the predetermined direction D2.

[0121] Hereinafter, a situation in which heat exchangers **30** and **40** of a heat exchanger unit according to another modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure are

connected by connection flow passage cap plates **71** and **72** to form a sensible heat flow passage and a latent heat flow passage connected together will be described below with reference to FIGS. **10** to **14** and **29**.

[0122] FIG. **10** is a view illustrating the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure when viewed from outside the second connection flow passage cap plate **72**. FIG. **11** is a view illustrating the first connection flow passage cap plate **71** of the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **12** is a view illustrating a partial area of a second main general side plate **5112** of the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure together with flow passage caps included in the second connection flow passage cap plate **72** when viewed from the outside along a predetermined direction. FIG. **13** is a view illustrating a first main general side plate **5111** of the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure together with flow passage caps included in the first connection flow passage cap plate **71** when viewed from the inside along a predetermined direction. FIG. **14** is a perspective view illustrating the sensible heat flow passage and the latent heat flow passage of the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **29** is a perspective view illustrating a situation in which the connection flow passage cap plates are separated from each other in the heat exchanger unit according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0123] FIG. **12** is view in which flow passage caps **722**, **723**, **724**, and **725** of the second connection flow passage cap plate **72** are illustrated by dotted lines on a view of the second main general side plate **5112**, straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** of a sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, and sensible heat insulation pipes **341** and **342** according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure when viewed from the second connection flow passage cap plate **72** of FIG. **29** along line H-H' FIG. **13** is view in which flow passage caps **712**, **713**, and **714** of the first connection flow passage cap plate **71** are illustrated by dotted lines on a view of the first main general side plate **5111**, the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** of the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, and the sensible heat insulation pipes **341** and **342** according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure when viewed along line G-G' of FIG. **29**.

[0124] In the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure, the latent heat flow passage that is connected to the sensible heat flow passage and through which heating-water flows is formed by a latent heat exchange pipe **42**, and the sensible heat flow passage through which the heating-water flows is formed by the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** and sensible heat insulation pipes **34**. In FIG. **14**, the latent heat flow passage is represented in the form of an arrow passing through the latent heat exchange pipe **42**, and the sensible heat flow passage is represented in the form of an arrow passing through the sensible heat exchange pipe **32** and the sensible heat insulation pipes **341** and **342**. For a better understanding of areas through which the flow passages pass, the flow passage caps of the connection flow passage cap plates **71** and **72** are not illustrated in FIG. **14** in a state in which general side plates, heat insulation side plates, and fins of the heat exchanger unit are removed. The sensible heat flow passage and the latent heat flow passage are connected to form an integrated heating-water flow passage. The sensible heat flow passage may include a series flow passage in at least a partial section, and the latent heat flow passage may include a parallel flow passage in at least a partial section. In the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure illustrated in FIGS. **10** to **14** and **29**, the sensible heat flow passage is configured to include only a series flow passage, and the latent heat flow passage is configured to include a parallel flow passage.

[0125] To form the heating-water flow passage without connection by a separate tube body, the connection flow passage cap plates **71** and **72** connecting the sensible heat exchanger **30** and the

latent heat exchanger **30** may be disposed in the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0126] To connect openings of the latent heat exchange pipe **42**, the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**, and the sensible heat insulation pipes **34** exposed outside the two main general side plates **5111** and **5112** of the main case (**51** of FIG. 2), the connection flow passage cap plates **71** and **72**, a kind of a flow passage cap plate, include flow passage caps having, between the main general side plate **511** and the flow passage caps, a connection space surrounding the openings.

[0127] To connect an outlet of the latent heat flow passage that is exposed outside a reference side plate, which is one of the two main general side plates **5111** and **5112**, and is formed by the latent heat exchange pipe **42** and an inlet of the sensible heat flow passage that is exposed outside the reference side plate and that introduces the heating-water into the sensible heat insulation pipes **34**, one of the connection flow passage cap plates **71** and **72** that is located on one side along the predetermined direction **D1** includes a connection flow passage cap having, between the reference side plate and the connection flow passage cap, a connection space surrounding the outlet of the latent heat flow passage and the inlet of the sensible heat flow passage.

[0128] In the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure, the reference side plate is the second main general side plate **5112**, and the one connection flow passage cap plate is the second connection flow passage cap plate **72** including the connection flow passage cap **722**. However, the position where the reference side plate is disposed is not limited thereto.

[0129] The connection flow passage cap **722** extends along the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas to connect the sensible heat exchanger **30** and the latent heat exchanger **40** stacked on each other. Furthermore, as the connection flow passage cap **722** connects a plurality of straight portions included in the latent heat exchange pipe **42** and the sensible heat insulation pipes **34**, the connection flow passage cap **722** may extend into the latent heat exchanger **40** while extending along the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. Accordingly, the connection flow passage cap **722** that is not completely parallel to the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas and that has a portion in an inclined form may be formed.

[0130] An inlet flow passage cap **721** having a heating-water supply hole **7211** formed therein and the outlet flow passage cap **725** having a heating-water discharge hole **7251** that is the outlet of the sensible heat flow passage are formed in the second connection flow passage cap plate **72**. The outlet of the sensible heat flow passage is implemented by the outlet of the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342**. In the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure, it is assumed that the heating-water is introduced into the latent heat exchanger **40** through the heating-water supply hole **7211**, the heating-water flows to the sensible heat exchanger **30** through the connection flow passage cap **722**, and the heating-water is heated and discharged through the heating-water discharge hole **7251** from the sensible heat exchanger **30**. However, the inlet flow passage cap **721** and the heating-water supply hole **7211** may be disposed to be connected with the sensible heat exchanger **30**, the outlet flow passage cap **725** and the heating-water discharge hole **7251** may be disposed to be connected with the latent heat exchanger **40**, and the heating-water flow passage may be formed in an opposite direction such that the heating-water passing through the sensible heat exchanger **30** faces toward the latent heat exchanger **40**.

[0131] The plurality of straight portions included in the latent heat exchange pipe **42** may be connected to the inlet flow passage cap **721** in parallel, and the heating-water introduced through the heating-water supply hole **7211** may move along the parallel flow passage. The outlet of the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** may be connected to the outlet flow passage cap **725**, and the outlet flow passage cap **725** may receive, from the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342**, the heating-water heated via the sensible heat flow passage and may discharge the heating-water.

[0132] When it is assumed that a virtual rectangular parallelepiped accommodates both the latent heat exchanger **40** and the sensible heat exchanger **30**, the heating-water supply hole **7211** that is

the inlet of the latent heat flow passage and the heating-water discharge hole **7251** that is the outlet of the sensible heat flow passage may be provided together on a reference surface that is one of the six surfaces of the rectangular parallelepiped. In other words, both the heating-water supply hole **7211** and the heating-water discharge hole **7251** may be provided in a flow passage cap plate that covers one of side plates constituting the main case (**51** of FIG. **1**). In the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure, the one side plate may be the second main general side plate **5111** that forms a connection space together with the flow passage caps of the second connection flow passage cap plate **72**, and the flow passage cap plate covering the one side plate is the second connection flow passage cap plate **72**. Accordingly, the heating-water is introduced into and discharged from the heat exchanger unit through a side surface on which the second connection flow passage cap plate **72** is disposed among side surfaces of the heat exchanger unit. However, the reference surface may be differently disposed without being limited thereto.

[0133] As the heating-water supply hole **7211** and the heating-water discharge hole **7251** are disposed in the same side surface of the heat exchanger unit, the direction in which the heating-water is introduced through the heating-water supply hole **7211** and the direction which the heating-water is discharged through the heating-water discharge hole **7251** may be opposite to each other. As the heating-water is introduced and discharged through the same side surface, a space required for arranging a heating-water pipe connected to the heating-water supply hole **7211** and the heating-water discharge hole **7251** may be saved. However, the heating-water supply hole **7211** and the heating-water discharge hole **7251** may be disposed in opposite side surfaces.

[0134] To locate the heating-water supply hole **7211** and the heating-water discharge hole **7251** in the same side surface, the heating-water flow passage may include an even number of sections in which the heating-water faces from one side to an opposite side of the predetermined direction **D2** or from the opposite side to the one side. That is, the number of times that the heating-water faces from one side surface to another side surface of the heat exchanger unit based on the predetermined direction **D2** may be an even number in the entire heating-water flow passage. In other words, when only a change in a progress direction from one side to an opposite side of the predetermined direction **D2** or from the opposite side to the one side is counted, the heating-water flow passage may change the direction an odd number of times. In the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure, the entire heating-water flow passage changes the direction a total of seven times, but the number of times is not limited thereto. In other words, in the latent heat flow passage and the sensible heat flow passage, the number of sections connecting the reference surface and the surface opposite to the reference surface along the predetermined direction **D2** may be an even number such that the heating-water flowing from the reference surface to the surface located on the opposite side to the reference surface returns to the reference surface again.

[0135] The description of the positions of the heating-water supply hole **7211** and the heating-water discharge hole **7251** of the first embodiment may be applied to other embodiments of the present disclosure and modified examples thereof.

[0136] The second connection flow passage cap plate **72** includes the second sensible heat flow passage cap **723** and the fourth sensible heat flow passage cap **724** that connect the straight portions **321**, **322**, **323**, and **324** included in the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**. The second sensible heat flow passage cap **723** may connect the first outer straight portion **321** and the intermediate straight portion **323** in series, and the third sensible heat flow passage cap **724** may connect the second outer straight portion **322** and the intermediate straight portion **324** in series.

[0137] The first connection flow passage cap plate **71** is coupled to the first main general side plate **5111** on the opposite side to the second connection flow passage cap plate **72** based on the sensible heat exchanger **30** and the latent heat exchanger **40**. Accordingly, the connection flow passage cap **722** is not formed, and the first connection flow passage cap plate **71** includes the latent heat flow passage cap **722** connecting the straight portions included in the latent heat exchange pipe **42**, the first sensible heat flow passage cap **712** connecting the straight portions included in the sensible

heat exchange pipe **32**, the third sensible heat flow passage cap **713**, and the fifth sensible heat flow passage cap **714**. In FIG. **11**, one latent heat flow passage cap **711** is formed. However, the number of latent heat flow passage caps **711** is not limited thereto, and a plurality of latent heat flow passage caps **711** may be formed.

[0138] The latent heat flow passage cap **711** may be connected with ends of the plurality of straight portions included in the latent heat exchange pipe **42**. Accordingly, the plurality of straight portions included in the latent heat exchange pipe **42** may form a parallel flow passage. The first sensible heat flow passage cap **712** may connect the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** and the first outer straight portion **321**, the third sensible heat flow passage cap **713** may connect the intermediate straight portions **323** and **324**, and the fifth sensible heat flow passage cap **714** may connect the second outer straight portion **322** and the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342**.

[0139] The description of the configuration of the latent heat flow passage including the parallel flow passage of the first embodiment may be applied to other embodiments of the present disclosure and modified examples thereof.

[0140] The heating-water flow passage formed by the first connection flow passage cap plate **71** and the second connection flow passage cap plate **72** according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure will be described along a flow of heating-water. The heating-water is introduced into the latent heat exchanger **40** through the heating-water supply hole **7211** formed in the inlet flow passage cap **721** of the second connection flow passage cap plate **72**. As the inlet flow passage cap **721** connects the plurality of straight portions of the latent heat exchange pipe **42** in parallel, the heating-water is delivered to the latent heat flow passage cap **711**, which is formed on the second connection flow passage cap plate **72**, along the parallel flow passage through the plurality of latent heat exchange pipes **42** connected to the inlet flow passage cap **721**.

[0141] As the latent heat flow passage cap **722** connects the latent heat exchange pipes **42** in parallel, the heating-water is delivered to the connection flow passage cap **713** through the plurality of latent heat exchange pipes **42** not connected with the inlet flow passage cap **712** and connected with the connection flow passage cap **713** in parallel. That is, the heating-water flows in parallel in the area of the heating-water flow passage that corresponds to the latent heat exchanger **40**.

[0142] The connection flow passage cap **722** is connected with the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341**. The heating-water flows through the first sensible heat insulation pipe **341** and is delivered to the first sensible heat flow passage cap **712** of the first connection flow passage cap plate **71**, and heat loss of the sensible heat exchanger **30** is interrupted.

[0143] The heating-water is delivered to the first outer straight portion **321** connected to the first sensible heat flow passage cap **712**. The heating-water is delivered to the second sensible heat flow passage cap **723**. As the intermediate straight portion **323** is connected to the second sensible heat flow passage cap **723**, the heating-water flows along the intermediate straight portion **323** and is delivered to the third sensible heat flow passage cap **713**. As the intermediate straight portion **324** is connected to the third sensible heat flow passage cap **713**, the heating-water flows along the intermediate straight portion **324** and is delivered to the fourth sensible heat flow passage cap **724**. As the second outer straight portion **322** is connected to the fourth sensible heat flow passage cap **724**, the heating-water flows along the second outer straight portion **322** and is delivered to the fifth sensible heat flow passage cap **714**. As the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** is connected to the fifth sensible heat flow passage cap **714**, the heating-water flows along the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** and is delivered to the outlet flow passage cap **725**.

[0144] That is, the heating-water flows along the sensible heat flow passage in series. The heating-water is heated by sensible heat while reciprocating between the first connection flow passage cap plate **71** and the second connection flow passage cap plate **72** and is delivered to the second sensible heat insulation pipe **342**.

[0145] The second sensible heat insulation pipe **342** interrupts heat loss of the sensible heat

exchanger **30** while delivering the heating-water to the outlet flow passage cap **725**, and the heating-water is discharged through the heating-water discharge hole **7251** and is used for heating.

Main Flow Passage

[0146] The condensing boiler **1** including the heat exchanger according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure includes the main flow passage. The main flow passage is a pipe that is directly or indirectly connected to a heating flow passage for providing heating and that supplies the heating-water to the heating flow passage. The main flow passage is directly or indirectly connected to the sensible heat exchanger **30** or the latent heat exchanger **40** and supplies the heating-water to the heat exchanger to heat the heating-water or supplies the heated heating-water from the heat exchanger to the heating flow passage. Accordingly, the heating-water pipe connected with the sensible heat exchanger **30** and the latent heat exchanger **40** to supply or receive the heating-water may be included in the main flow passage.

Second Embodiment

[0147] FIG. **15** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to the second embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0148] Referring to FIG. **15**, the heat exchanger unit according to the second embodiment of the present disclosure may have a sensible heat exchanger **81** and a latent heat exchanger **82** having two rows of latent heat exchangers. A first latent heat exchanger **821** located at an upstream side based on a flow direction of combustion gas may have a greater width in an orthogonal direction than a second latent heat exchanger **822**.

[0149] Furthermore, the heat exchanger unit according to the second embodiment of the present disclosure may have a larger number of straight portions **8211** included in a latent heat exchange pipe and a larger number of straight portions **811** included in a sensible heat exchange pipe than the heat exchanger units according to the first embodiment of the present disclosure and the one modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure. The number of straight portions that the first latent heat exchanger **821** has may be larger than the number of straight portions that the second latent heat exchanger **821** has.

[0150] FIG. **16** is a front view illustrating a flow passage cap plate **90** of a heat exchanger unit according to a modified example of the second embodiment of the present disclosure together with pipes. The pipes are illustrated by dotted lines.

[0151] Referring to FIG. **16**, the flow passage cap plate **90** of the heat exchanger unit according to the modified example of the second embodiment of the present disclosure includes a heating-water discharge hole **91** not formed through a flow passage cap and directly formed through the flow passage cap plate **90**. The heating-water discharge hole **91** may not be located downstream of a sensible heat exchange pipe **95** along a flow direction **D1** of combustion gas and may be disposed on the same line along an orthogonal direction so as to be adjacent to the sensible heat exchange pipe **95**.

[0152] The flow passage cap plate **90** according to the modified example of the second embodiment of the present disclosure may include a modified connection flow passage cap **92**. When the modified connection flow passage cap **92** is compared with the connection flow passage cap (**722** of FIG. **10**) according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure, the length of an inclined portion **922** formed to be inclined with respect to the orthogonal direction and the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas is smaller than the length of a portion **923** extending along the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas and the length of a portion **921** extending along the orthogonal direction. Furthermore, when the modified connection flow passage cap **92** is compared with the connection flow passage cap (**722** of FIG. **10**) according to the other modified example of the first embodiment of the present disclosure, the width of the inclined portion **922** is smaller than the width of the portion **921** extending along the orthogonal direction.

[0153] Due to the position of the heating-water discharge hole **912** and the shape of the connection

flow passage cap **92**, the flow passage cap plate **90** may have an asymmetrical structure that does not have line symmetry with respect to a line parallel to the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. The flow passage cap plate **90** may have a tapered shape having a decreasing width along the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. In FIG. **16**, a left inclined portion **93** and a right inclined portion **94** may be configured to have tapered outer surfaces from different locations to other different locations based on the flow direction **D1** of the combustion gas. This is to reduce a waste of material by cutting a portion corresponding to an unnecessary area.

[0154] The shapes of the sensible heat exchanger **81** and the latent heat exchanger **82** according to the second embodiment or the shape of the flow passage cap plate **90** according to the modified example of the second embodiment may be applied to other embodiments of the present disclosure and modified examples thereof.

Third Embodiment

[0155] FIG. **17** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit and a condensing boiler **2** using the same according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **18** is a side view of the heat exchanger unit and the condensing boiler **2** using the same according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0156] Referring to the drawings, the condensing boiler **2** according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure includes a combustion chamber **20** and the heat exchanger unit.

[0157] Furthermore, the condensing boiler **2** including the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure includes a burner assembly **10** including a burner **11**. The burner assembly **10** and the heat exchanger unit are disposed in sequence along a reference direction **D1**, which is a flow direction of combustion gas, and components are arranged in the heat exchanger unit along the same direction in the order of the combustion chamber **20** and the heat exchanger unit. Accordingly, the components of the condensing boiler **2** will be described below in the above-described order of arrangement.

[0158] The heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure, and the burner assembly **10**, the combustion chamber **20**, a condensate receiver **55**, a condensate outlet **53**, and an exhaust duct **52** included in the condensing boiler **2** using the heat exchanger unit are identical or very similar to the corresponding components of the first embodiment. Therefore, descriptions thereof are replaced with the above-described contents of the first embodiment.

Heat Exchanger Unit

[0159] FIG. **19** is a plan view of the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **20** is a vertical sectional view of the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0160] Referring to the drawings, the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure includes a sensible heat exchanging part **300** and a latent heat exchanging part **400**. Furthermore, the heat exchanger unit of the present disclosure may include a housing **510** that defines heat exchange areas inside by surrounding a sensible heat exchange area and a latent heat exchange area in which the heat exchanging parts **300** and **400** are disposed.

[0161] The sensible heat exchanging part **300** and the latent heat exchanging part **400** may be disposed in the sensible heat exchange area and the latent heat exchange area, respectively. The sensible heat exchange area and the latent heat exchange area may be connected, and the combustion gas delivered from the combustion chamber **20** may flow in the sensible heat exchange area and the latent heat exchange area along the reference direction **D1** that is the flow direction.

Heat Exchanger Unit-Sensible Heat Exchanging Part **300**

[0162] The sensible heat exchange area is an area that is located downstream of the combustion chamber **20** based on the reference direction **D1** and that receives sensible heat generated at the upstream side and heats heating-water. The size of the sensible heat exchange area is determined by a space from the most upstream side to the most downstream side of the sensible heat exchanging part **300** along the reference direction **D1** in the space surrounded by the housing **510**. Accordingly,

the sensible heat exchange area may be connected with an interior space **22** of the combustion chamber **20** and may receive radiant heat from the burner **11**, and the combustion gas may flow in the sensible heat exchange area. Furthermore, because the sensible heat exchange area has to be able to transfer sensible heat to the heating-water, the sensible heat exchanging part **300** including a sensible heat exchange pipe **320** and a sensible heat fin **330** is disposed in the sensible heat exchange area.

[0163] The sensible heat exchange pipe **320** is a pipe type component through which the heating-water flows and around which the combustion gas flows. The sensible heat exchange pipe **320** extends along a predetermined direction **D2** in the sensible heat exchange area **32**. The predetermined direction **D2** may preferably be a direction perpendicular to the reference direction **D1**. The sensible heat exchange pipe **320** may extend along the predetermined direction **D2** and may be coupled to the housing **510**.

[0164] The sensible heat exchange pipe **320** may include a plurality of sensible heat straight portions. The sensible heat straight portions may be arranged to be spaced apart from each other along an orthogonal direction perpendicular to the predetermined direction **D2**. The plurality of sensible heat straight portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** may be coupled to flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** of the housing **510**, which will be described below, to form one sensible heat flow passage through which the heating-water flows.

[0165] The sensible heat fin **330** is formed in a plate shape across the direction in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** extends, and the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** passes through the sensible heat fin **330**. As the sensible heat fin **330** has a shape through which the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** passes, the sensible heat exchanging part **300** may configure a heat exchanger of a fin-tube type.

[0166] As the sensible heat exchanging part **300** includes the sensible heat fin **330**, the thermal conductivity of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** may be raised. A plurality of sensible heat fins **330** may be disposed to be spaced apart from each other at predetermined intervals along the predetermined direction **D2** in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** extends. The sensible heat fin **330** may transfer a larger amount of sensible heat to the heating-water by increasing the surface area of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** capable of receiving sensible heat. Accordingly, for effective heat transfer, the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** and the sensible heat fin **330** may be formed of metal having a high thermal conductivity.

[0167] A cross-section obtained by cutting the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** with a plane perpendicular to the predetermined direction **D2** in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** extends may be formed in the shape of a long hole that extends along the reference direction **D1**. As can be seen in the drawings, the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure may have a flat shape formed such that a value obtained by dividing the length of the interior space in the cross-section based on the reference direction **D1** by the width according to the direction perpendicular to the reference direction **D1** equals 2 or more. When the flat type pipe having the above-described shape is employed for the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**, due to a wider heat exchange area in the relationship with the combustion gas, the heating-water may receive a larger amount of heat and may be sufficiently heated even though flowing along the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** having the same length, as compared with when a pipe having a different shape, such as a circular shape or an oval shape, is employed for the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**.

[0168] A through-hole through which the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** passes may be formed in the sensible heat fin **330**. The area of the through-hole may be equal to or smaller than the area of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**, and the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** may be firmly inserted into the through-hole. Furthermore, the sensible heat fin **330** may be integrally coupled with the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** through brazing welding. A method of coupling the sensible heat fin **330** and the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** through brazing welding will be

described in detail in the descriptions of FIGS. 15 and 16.

[0169] Common louver holes **3303** and **3304** may be additionally formed in the sensible heat fin **330** along the direction in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** extends. The louver holes **3303** and **3304** may be formed by punching. The louver holes **3303** and **3304** include a burr raised along the periphery thereof. When the combustion gas flows, the burr blocks the combustion gas to cause the combustion gas to flow around the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**, thereby facilitating heat exchange between the combustion gas and the heating-water. A plurality of louver holes **3303** and **3304** may be formed. The louver holes **3303** and **3304**, as illustrated in the drawings, may include the first louver holes **3303** that extend in an oblique direction with respect to the reference direction **D1** and the second louver holes **3304** that are formed between the adjacent sensible heat straight portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** and that extend in the orthogonal direction perpendicular to the reference direction **D1**. The louver holes **3303** and **3304** may be disposed to be spaced apart from each other at predetermined intervals along the reference direction **D1**.

[0170] The sensible heat fin **330** may further include valleys **3302** and protruding portions **3301**. The sensible heat fin **330** may be basically formed to surround the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**. The sensible heat fin **330** may surround areas corresponding to a predetermined width from the peripheries of upstream-side end portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** based on the reference direction **D1** such that the areas are distinguished from the remaining areas of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**. Accordingly, between the adjacent upstream-side end portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**, the valleys **3302** may be concavely formed in the sensible heat fin **330** along the reference direction **D1**. The areas of the sensible heat fin **330** that are adjacent to the upstream-side end portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** relatively protrude to form the protruding portions **3301**. Unnecessary areas are open by forming the valleys **3302**, and thus the combustion gas may more freely flow between the sensible heat fin **330** and the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**.

Heat Exchanger Unit-Latent Heat Exchanging Part **400**

[0171] The latent heat exchange area is an area that is located downstream of the sensible heat exchange area based on the reference direction **D1** and that receives latent heat generated during a phase change of the combustion gas and heats the heating-water. The size of the latent heat exchange area is determined by a space from the most upstream side to the most downstream side of the latent heat exchanging part **400** along the reference direction **D1** in the space surrounded by the housing **510**. The latent heat exchanging part **400** that includes a latent heat exchange pipe **420** through which the heating-water flows and around which the combustion gas flows and a latent heat fin **430** that is formed in a plate shape across the predetermined direction **D2**, in which the latent heat exchange pipe **420** extends, and through which the latent heat exchange pipe **420** passes is disposed in the latent heat exchange area.

[0172] The configurations of the latent heat exchange pipe **420** and the latent heat fin **430** are similar to the configurations of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** and the sensible heat fin **330**. Therefore, descriptions of basic structures of the latent heat exchange pipe **420** and the latent heat fin **430** are replaced with the above descriptions of the structures of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** and the sensible heat fin **330**. Accordingly, the latent heat exchanging part **400** may also be configured in a fin-tube type.

[0173] The latent heat exchange pipe **420** may include a plurality of upstream straight portions **421** and a plurality of downstream straight portions **422** located downstream of the upstream straight portions **421** based on the reference direction **D1**. One of the plurality of downstream straight portions **422** may be connected with one upstream straight portion **421** among the plurality of upstream straight portions **421**. That is, the latent heat exchange pipe **420** may be disposed in two rows. The latent heat exchange pipe **420** may be disposed to have more than two rows. As the latent heat exchange pipe **420** has the plurality of rows of straight portions, the latent heat exchange pipe **420** may improve thermal efficiency that is likely to be degraded when a fin-tube type is used.

[0174] In FIG. 20, four upstream straight portions **421** and three downstream straight portions **422** are disposed. This is because the reference cross-sectional area of the latent heat exchange area is decreased along the reference direction **D1** as will be described below. However, the number of latent heat straight portions **421** and **422** constituting the latent heat exchange pipe **420** and extending in the predetermined direction **D2** is not limited thereto.

[0175] As the latent heat exchange pipe **420** is disposed in two rows, the latent heat fin **430** may also be disposed to be separated depending on the latent heat exchange pipe **420**. That is, an upstream fin **431** included in the latent heat fin **430** may be coupled to the upstream straight portions **421**, and a downstream fin **432** included in the latent heat fin **430** may be coupled to the downstream straight portions **422**.

[0176] As the latent heat exchange pipe **420** is disposed in two rows, a situation in which the combustion gas fails to sufficiently transfer heat to the heating-water due to a deficiency of a heat transfer area in the latent heat exchange area may be prevented, and as sufficient heat exchange occurs over a wide area for the entire combustion gas, a fraction at which the combustion gas is discharged without experiencing a phase change may be reduced.

[0177] The cross-sectional area of the interior spaces of the latent heat straight portions **421** and **422** of the latent heat exchange pipe **420** may be smaller than the cross-sectional area of the interior spaces of the sensible heat straight portions of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**. Instead of making the cross-sectional area of the latent heat straight portions **421** and **422** smaller than the cross-sectional area of the interior spaces of the sensible heat straight portions, the total number of sensible heat straight portions may be made smaller than the total number of latent heat straight portions **421** and **422** such that the product of the cross-sectional area of the interior spaces of the sensible heat straight portions and the total length of the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** remains at a numerical value corresponding to the product of the cross-sectional area of the interior spaces of the latent heat straight portions **421** and **422** and the total length of the latent heat exchange pipe **420**.

[0178] In other words, the latent heat exchange pipe **420** may be formed such that in a cross-section obtained by cutting the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** with a plane perpendicular to the direction in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** extends, the number of closed curves formed by the peripheries of the sensible heat straight portions is smaller than the number of closed curves formed by the peripheries of the latent heat straight portions **421** and **422**. In a case where the same number of or more pipes having a larger cross-sectional area than the latent heat straight portions **421** and **422** are disposed in the sensible heat exchanging part **300**, when the heating-water moves to the adjacent sensible heat exchange pipe **320** via the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364**, the heating-water may not be efficiently circulated due to a rapid pressure drop in the heating-water that occurs in a section where a flow passage is sharply bent. Accordingly, the cross-sectional areas and the total numbers of the sensible heat exchange pipes **320** and the latent heat exchange pipes **420** are adjusted as described above. The contents regarding the cross-sectional areas and the total numbers of the heat exchange pipes may be applied to other embodiments and modified examples thereof. Likewise to the sensible heat fin **330**, a plurality of latent heat fins **430** are disposed to be spaced apart from each other at predetermined intervals along the direction in which the latent heat exchange pipe **420** extends.

[0179] One or more layers in which the latent heat fins **430** located in the same position based on the reference direction **D1** are disposed may be formed. The total number of latent heat fins **430** disposed in the layer most adjacent to the sensible heat fin **330** among the layers may be smaller than the total number of sensible heat fins **330**.

[0180] Referring to the drawings, a total of two layers including one layer formed by the upstream fin **431** and one layer formed by the downstream fin **432** may be disposed. The upstream fin **431** is disposed in the layer most adjacent to the sensible heat fin **330** among the layers. The total number of upstream fins **431** may be smaller than the total number of sensible heat fins **330**.

[0181] The distance by which the adjacent two latent heat fins **430** are spaced apart from each other may be longer than the distance by which the adjacent two sensible heat fins **330** are spaced apart from each other. To prevent condensate from being easily formed between the latent heat fins **430** and hampering a movement of the combustion gas, the interval between the latent heat fins **430** is greater than the interval between the sensible heat fins **330**. In the latent heat fin **430**, the distance by which the adjacent two downstream fins **432** are spaced apart from each other may be longer than the distance by which the adjacent two upstream fins **431** are spaced apart from each other.

[0182] A predetermined interval at which the adjacent latent heat fins **430** are spaced apart from each other along the predetermined direction D2 may be a distance by which condensate formed by condensation of the combustion gas between the adjacent latent heat fins **430** does not connect the adjacent latent heat fins **430**. That is, the distance between the adjacent latent heat fins **430** may be an interval by which condensate is easily discharged.

[0183] FIG. **21** is a perspective view illustrating a plurality of downstream fins **432** according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure and condensate W located therebetween. The distance between the adjacent latent heat fins **430** will be described with reference to FIG. **21**, with the downstream fins **432** among the latent heat fins **430** as an example.

[0184] Drops of condensate may be formed and attached to surfaces of the downstream fins **432**. The drops of condensate formed on the surfaces of the adjacent downstream fins **432** may be combined to form a large drop of condensate W that blocks the space between the latent heat fins **430**, and the combustion gas may not smoothly move along the reference direction D1 due to the large drop of condensate W. Accordingly, the downstream fins **432** are disposed to be spaced apart from each other at a predetermined interval or more such that the drops of condensate are not combined with each other and the combustion gas flows between the adjacent downstream fins **432**.

[0185] Specifically, the interval by which the condensate W is easily discharged refers to the interval between the adjacent downstream fins **432** in a state in which the weight of the condensate W formed between the downstream fins **432** is greater than the vertical resultant force of tensions T acting between the downstream fins **432** and the condensate W.

[0186] Referring to the drawing, the condensate W exists between the downstream fins **432** that are spaced apart from each other by a distance of d and adjacent to each other and that have a width of b in the predetermined direction D2. At this time, the weight (or, the body force) of the condensate W formed to a height of h is represented by the product of the volume of the condensate W (the distance d x the width b x the height h) and the specific gravity Y of the condensate W. The weight acts on the condensate in the vertically downward direction.

[0187] Meanwhile, the force acting on the condensate W in the vertically upward direction is formed by the resultant force of surface tensions. The distance d satisfying Equation 1 below is the interval by which the condensate W is easily discharged, where θ is the angle that a line extending from the surface of the condensate W forms with each of the downstream fins **432** and T is surface tension by which the condensate W is pulled by the downstream fin **432**.

[00001] $b \times d \times h \times g \geq 2(T \times b \times \cos \theta)$ [Equation1]

[0188] Here, g is the acceleration of gravity. When Equation 1 above is balanced under the assumption that other conditions are equal, the height h of the condensate W and the interval d between the downstream fins **432** by which the condensate W is easily discharged have an inverse relationship. Accordingly, the interval by which the condensate is easily discharged may be determined by selecting an appropriate height of the condensate desired to be discharged from the latent heat exchanger **40**.

[0189] Tension T measured in one situation is 0.073 N/m. At room temperature, the specific gravity of the condensate is 1000 kg/m.³, θ may be approximated to 0 degrees, and g may be approximated to 9.8 m/s.². As the height h of the condensate mainly ranges from 5 mm to 8

mm, the predetermined interval d of 1.9 mm to 3 mm may be obtained in the one situation by substituting the values into Equation 1. The descriptions of the number of fins and the interval may be applied to other embodiments of the present disclosure and modified examples thereof.

Heat Exchanger Unit-Housing **510** and Flow Passage Cap Plates **363** and **364**

[0190] The housing **510** will be described below with reference to FIGS. **17** to **20**. The housing **510** is a component that surrounds and defines the sensible heat exchange area and the latent heat exchange area and may include a heat insulation side plate **5120** and a general side plate **5110**. The general side plate **5110** may include a first general side plate **5113** and a second general side plate **5114** spaced apart from each other along the predetermined direction D2 and covered by the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364**. The heat insulation side plate **5120** is a plate-shaped component extending along the reference direction D1 and the predetermined direction D2. Two heat insulation side plates **5120** may be disposed to be spaced apart from each other in the orthogonal direction. Accordingly, the heat insulation side plates **5120** form two side surfaces of the heat exchanger unit. The lateral shapes of the sensible heat exchange area and the latent heat exchange area are determined depending on the shape of inner surfaces of the heat insulation side plates **5120**.

[0191] Here, the heat insulation side plates **5120** are used with the meaning of side plates to which sensible heat insulation pipes **340** are disposed to be adjacent, rather than the meaning of side plates that reduce the amount of heat transferred to the outside, thereby achieving thermal insulation. The sensible heat insulation pipes **340** may be additionally disposed adjacent to the heat insulation side plates **5120**. The sensible heat insulation pipes **34** are pipe type components that are disposed adjacent to the housing **510** surrounding the sensible heat exchange area and that allow the heating-water to flow therethrough to reduce the amount by which heat of the sensible heat exchange area is released outside the housing **510**. As illustrated, two sensible heat insulation pipes **340** may extend in the predetermined direction D2 that is the same as the direction in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** extends.

[0192] As illustrated in the drawings, the sensible heat insulation pipes **340** may be formed in an oval shape in a cross-section obtained by cutting the sensible heat insulation pipes **340** with a plane perpendicular to the direction in which sensible heat insulation pipes **340** extend. Specifically, the sensible heat insulation pipes **340** may be formed in an oval shape having a long axis parallel to the reference direction D1. The description of the sensible heat insulation pipes (**34** of FIG. **2**) of the first embodiment may be identically applied to the sensible heat insulation pipes **340** of the third embodiment.

[0193] The general side plates **5110** and the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** are plate-shaped components extending along the reference direction D1 and the orthogonal direction. The two general side plates **5110** may be disposed to be spaced apart from each other in the predetermined direction D2 in which the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** or the latent heat exchange pipe **420** extends. The two general side plates **5110**, when being disposed, may be disposed at opposite ends of the sensible heat straight portions and the latent heat straight portions **421** and **422**. The opposite ends of the sensible heat straight portions and the latent heat straight portions **421** and **422** may be coupled through the two general side plates **5113** and **5114**. Likewise, the two flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** may be coupled while covering the general side plates **5110** from the outside. Accordingly, the general side plates **5110** and the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** may form the remaining two side surfaces of the heat exchanger unit that the heat insulation side plates **512** do not cover. Other lateral shapes of the sensible heat exchange area and the latent heat exchange area are determined depending on the shape of inner surfaces of the general side plates **5110**.

[0194] The flow passage cap plates **312** and **313** may include the second flow passage cap plate **364** and the first flow passage cap plate **363** on which a plurality of flow passage caps are formed. The second flow passage cap plate **364** and the first flow passage cap plate **363** may cover the second general side plate **5114** and the first general side plate **5113** and may be disposed adjacent to

the opposite ends of the sensible heat straight portions or the latent heat straight portions **421** and **422**. A heating-water supply hole **3710** and a heating-water discharge hole **3720** may be disposed in the second flow passage cap plate **364**. The heating-water supply hole **3710** may be an opening through which the heating-water is supplied from the outside to one end of an integrated latent heat flow passage formed by the latent heat exchange pipe **420** and may be an inlet of the latent heat flow passage, and the heating-water discharge hole **3720** may be an opening through which the heating-water is discharged to the outside from one end of an integrated sensible heat flow passage formed by the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** and may be an outlet of the sensible heat flow passage.

[0195] The heating-water may be introduced from the outside through the heating-water supply hole **3710** located at a relatively downstream side based on the reference direction **D1** and may be delivered to the latent heat exchange pipe **420**. The heating-water heated in the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** may be discharged to the outside through the heating-water discharge hole **3720** located at a relatively upstream side based on the reference direction **D1**. However, the positions of the heating-water supply hole **3710** and the heating-water discharge hole **3720** are not limited thereto.

[0196] To connect the outlet of the latent heat flow passage exposed outside one of the side plates constituting the housing **510** and the inlet of the sensible heat flow passage exposed outside the one side plate, one of the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** may include, between the one side plate and the one flow passage cap plate, a flow passage cap having a connection space surrounding the outlet of the latent heat flow passage and the inlet of the sensible heat flow passage. In the third embodiment of the present disclosure, the flow passage cap may be a second flow passage cap **3642** provided on the second flow passage cap plate **364**. Accordingly, one of the side plates is the second general side plate **5112** that forms the connection space together with the second flow passage cap plate **364**. However, the side plate and the flow passage cap plate that connect the inlet of the sensible heat flow passage and the outlet of the latent heat flow passage are not limited thereto.

[0197] The descriptions of the heating-water pipe and the main flow passage of the first embodiment may be applied to a heating-water pipe and a main flow passage that are connected to the heating-water supply hole **3710** and the heating-water discharge hole **3720** of the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

Shape of Heat Exchange Area Formed by Housing **510**

[0198] The cross-sectional area of each heat exchange area defined on a plane perpendicular to the reference direction **D1** is referred to as a reference cross-sectional area. The housing **510** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area at the most downstream side is smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the most upstream side based on the reference direction **D1**. The housing **510** may be provided such that at least one section in which the reference cross-sectional area of the heat exchange area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1** is formed to allow the combustion gas to flow at higher speed in the latent heat exchange area than in the sensible heat exchange area.

[0199] The housing **510** may be formed to include at least one section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1**. Accordingly, the heat exchange area may have a tapered shape along the reference direction **D1** as a whole. As the housing **510** is formed such that the reference cross-sectional area of the heat exchange area decreases, the occurrence of a dead zone where heat transfer efficiency is deteriorated due to a sharp reduction in flow speed at a specific position when the combustion gas flows in the latent heat exchange area may be prevented by Bernoulli's principle. In particular, in a case where the latent heat exchange pipe **420** is formed of two or more layers as in the third embodiment of the present disclosure, the condensate may block the space between the latent heat fins **430**, or the length of the latent heat exchange area along the reference direction **D1** may become longer, and thus thermal efficiency

may be deteriorated. However, the problem may be overcome because the heat exchange area has a tapered shape due to the housing. Specifically, the housing **510** may be formed to include at least one section in which the width of the heat exchange area in the orthogonal direction gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1**, and the width of the heat exchange area in the predetermined direction **D2** may be formed to remain constant along the reference direction **D1**. That is, the reference cross-sectional area is decreased by reducing only the width in the orthogonal direction in a state in which the width in the predetermined direction **D2** is maintained along the reference direction **D1**. To form the above-described shape, the general side plates **5110** may be formed in a general plate shape, and the heat insulation side plates **5120** may be formed to be bent as illustrated.

[0200] Specifically, referring to FIG. **20**, a section corresponding to the latent heat exchange area is a section from a second point **A2** at which the inlet end of the upstream fin **431** is located to a point at which the outlet end of the downstream fin **432** is located. A section in which the reference cross-sectional area decreases along the reference direction **D1** in the latent heat exchange area is formed between the second point **A2** and a third point **A3** and between a fourth point **A4** and a sixth point **A6**. A section in which the reference cross-sectional area is maintained is formed between the third point **A3** and the fourth point **A4** and between the sixth point **A6** and the outlet end of the downstream fin **432**. Furthermore, a section between a first point **A1** and the second point **A2** that does not correspond to the latent heat exchange area, but is part of the heat exchange area is also a section in which the reference cross-sectional area decreases along the reference direction **D1**.

[0201] In FIG. **20**, it can be seen that the heat exchange area is formed to include at least one section in which the width in the orthogonal direction decreases along the reference direction **D1** and at least one section in which the width in the orthogonal direction remains constant.

[0202] Specifically, it can be seen that the width of the latent heat exchange area in the orthogonal direction decreases along the reference direction **D1** in the section from the second point **A2** to the third point **A3** and in the section from the fourth point **A4** to the sixth point **A6**. In contrast, it can be seen that the width in the orthogonal direction remains constant in the section from the third point **A3** to the fourth point **A4** and in the section from the sixth point **A6** to the most downstream side of the housing **510**.

[0203] It can be seen that in the section in which the straight portions **421** and **422** of the latent heat exchange pipe **420** are located, the width in the orthogonal direction approximately remains constant and heat exchange is sufficiently performed, and in the section located between the straight portions, the reference cross-sectional area decreases along the reference direction **D1** to increase flow speed.

[0204] The shape of the heat exchange area may be described by defining the most upstream side of each fin **330**, **432**, or **432** based on the reference direction **D1** as an inlet end and defining the most downstream side as an outlet end. The housing **510** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases from the outlet end of the sensible heat fin **330** to the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430** along the reference direction **D1**. That is, in FIG. **20**, the housing **510** may be formed such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1** in the section from the first point **A1** at which the outlet end of the sensible heat fin **330** is located to the second point **A2** at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430** is located.

[0205] The housing **510** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area of the inlet end of the downstream fin **432** is smaller than the reference cross-sectional area of the inlet end of the upstream fin **431**. That is, the section between the second point **A2** and a fifth point **A5** includes at least one section in which the reference cross-sectional area decreases along the reference direction **D1**, such that the reference cross-sectional area at the fifth point **A5** at which the inlet end of the downstream fin **432** is located is smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the second point **A2** at which the inlet end of the upstream fin **431** is located.

[0206] Referring to FIG. **20**, the housing **510** may be formed such that the reference cross-sectional

area of a partial section of the sensible heat exchange area also decreases along the reference direction **D1**.

[0207] As the width of the heat exchange area is changed as described above, each fin may have a section in which the width in the orthogonal direction decreases along the reference direction **D1**.

[0208] The area of the sensible heat fin **330** or the latent heat fin **430** in the heat exchange area that makes contact with the inner surface of the housing **510** may be provided such that the width gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1** to correspond to a gradual reduction in the reference cross-sectional area based on the width of a fin defined in a direction perpendicular to the reference direction **D1**. Referring to FIG. **20**, it can be seen that the area adjacent to the outlet end of the sensible heat fin **330** and the width of the upstream fin **431** located in the section from the fourth point **A4** to the outlet end of the upstream fin **431** decrease along the reference direction **D1** depending on the shape of the inner surface of the housing **510**.

[0209] FIG. **22** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to a first modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0210] In FIG. **22**, the form of the heat exchanger unit according to the first modified example of the third embodiment that has one row of sensible heat exchange pipes **320** and two rows of latent heat exchange pipes **420** as in the third embodiment of the present disclosure may be identified.

[0211] A housing **510b** according to the first modified example of the third embodiment may also be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area at the most downstream side is smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the most upstream side based on a reference direction **D1**.

[0212] The housing **510b** may be provided such that at least one section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1** is formed to allow combustion gas to flow at higher speed in a latent heat exchange area than in a sensible heat exchange area. Descriptions of effects obtained by the heat exchanger unit as the section in which the reference cross-sectional area decreases is disposed are replaced with the contents described above with reference to FIG. **20**.

[0213] The housing **510b** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases from the outlet end of a sensible heat fin **330b** to the inlet end of a latent heat fin **430b**. The housing **510b** may be formed such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1** in the section from a first point **B1** at which the outlet end of the sensible heat fin **330b** is located to a second point **B2** at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430b** is located.

[0214] In the section from the second point **B2** at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430b** is located to the outlet end of a downstream fin **432b**, a heat exchange area may have only a section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1** and a section in which the reference cross-sectional area is maintained. Accordingly, the reference cross-sectional area at the outlet end of the downstream fin **432b** may be smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the second point **B2**.

[0215] The housing **510b** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases from the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430b** to the outlet end of the latent heat fin **430b**. The housing **510b** may be formed such that the reference cross-sectional area of the section from the second point **B2** at which the inlet end of an upstream fin **431b**, which is a kind of the latent heat fin **430b**, is located to a third point **b3** at which the outlet end of the upstream fin **431b** is located gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1**.

[0216] The housing **510b** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area at the inlet end of the downstream fin **432b** is smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the inlet end of the upstream fin **431b**. The housing **510b** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1** in the section from the second point **B2** at which the inlet end of the upstream fin **431b** is located to a fourth point **B4** at which the inlet end of the downstream fin **432b** is located, and the condition may be satisfied.

[0217] Referring to the drawing, the latent heat exchange area may have a section from the second point B2 to a fifth point B5 in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction D1 and a section from the fifth point B5 to the outlet end of the downstream fin **432b** in which the reference cross-sectional area remains constant.

[0218] The area of the latent heat fin **430b** that makes contact with the inner surface of the housing **510b** may be provided such that the width gradually decreases along the reference direction D1 to correspond to a gradual reduction in the reference cross-sectional area based on the width of the fin defined in an orthogonal direction. Referring to the drawing, the housing **510b** is provided such that the reference cross-sectional area of the section from the second point B2 at which the inlet end of the upstream fin **431b** is located to the third point B3 at which the outlet end is located gradually decreases along the reference direction D1. Accordingly, a tapered shape may be formed such that the width of the upstream fin **431b** defined in the orthogonal direction gradually decreases along the reference direction D1.

[0219] FIG. 23 is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to a second modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0220] In FIG. 23, the form of the heat exchanger unit according to the second modified example of the third embodiment that has one row of sensible heat exchange pipes **320c** and two rows of latent heat exchange pipes **420c** as in the third embodiment of the present disclosure may be identified. The heat exchange pipes of the second modified example differ from the heat exchange pipes of the third embodiment in that in this modified example, the sensible heat exchange pipes **320c** include a total of five straight portions and a total of six upstream straight portions **421c** are disposed.

[0221] A housing **510c** according to the second modified example of the third embodiment may also be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area at the most downstream side is smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the most upstream side based on a reference direction D1.

[0222] The housing **510c** may be provided such that at least one section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction D1 is formed to allow combustion gas to flow at higher speed in a latent heat exchange area than in a sensible heat exchange area. Descriptions of effects obtained by the heat exchanger unit as the section in which the reference cross-sectional area decreases is disposed are replaced with the contents described above with reference to FIG. 20.

[0223] The housing **510c** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases from the outlet end of a sensible heat fin **330c** to the inlet end of a latent heat fin **430c**. The housing **510c** may be formed such that the reference cross-sectional area of the section from a first point C1 at which the outlet end of the sensible heat fin **330c** is located to a second point C2 at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430c** is located gradually decreases along the reference direction D1.

[0224] The housing **510c** may be provided such that in the section from the second point C2 at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430c** is located to the outlet end of a downstream fin **432c**, a heat exchange area has only a section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction D1 and a section in which the reference cross-sectional area is maintained. Accordingly, the reference cross-sectional area at the outlet end of the downstream fin **432c** may be smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the second point C2.

[0225] By more specifically limiting the shape of the latent heat exchange area, the housing **510c** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area at the inlet end of the downstream fin **432c** is smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the inlet end of an upstream fin **431c**. The housing **510c** may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction D1 in the section from the second point C2 at which the inlet end of the upstream fin **431c** is located to a fifth point C5 at which the inlet end of the downstream fin **432c** is located, and the condition may be satisfied.

[0226] Referring to the drawing, the latent heat exchange area may have a section from the second point C2 to a third point C3 and a section from the fifth point C5 to a sixth point C6, which are sections in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction D1, and a section from the third point C3 to a fourth point C4 and a section from the sixth point C6 to the outlet end of the downstream fin 432c, which are sections in which the reference cross-sectional area remains constant.

[0227] According to the second modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure, the inlet end of one of the latent heat fins 430c may be formed to be flat without having a plurality of valleys and protruding portions, like another fin.

[0228] FIG. 24 is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to a third modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0229] Referring to FIG. 24, the heat exchanger unit according to the third modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure includes one row of sensible heat exchange pipes 320e and one row of latent heat exchange pipes 420e. The sensible heat exchange pipes 320e include four straight portions, and the latent heat exchange pipes 420e include six straight portions.

However, the numbers of straight portions are not limited thereto.

[0230] A housing 510e according to the third modified example of the third embodiment may also be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area at the most downstream side is smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the most upstream side based on a reference direction D1.

[0231] The housing 510e may be provided such that at least one section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction D1 is formed to allow combustion gas to flow at higher speed in a latent heat exchange area than in a sensible heat exchange area. Descriptions of effects obtained by the heat exchanger unit as the section in which the reference cross-sectional area decreases is disposed are replaced with the contents described above with reference to FIG. 20.

[0232] The housing 510e may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases from the outlet end of a sensible heat fin 330e to the inlet end of a latent heat fin 430e. The housing 510e may be formed such that the reference cross-sectional area is maintained in the section from a first point E1 at which the outlet end of the sensible heat fin 330e is located to a second point E2 located downstream of the first point E1 and the reference cross-sectional area of the section from the second point E2 to a third point E3 at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin 430e is located gradually decreases along the reference direction D1. Accordingly, the reference cross-sectional area does not increase from the outlet end of the sensible heat fin 330e to the inlet end of the latent heat fin 430e.

[0233] The housing 510e may be provided such that in the section from the third point E3 at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin 430e is located to a fifth point E5 at which the outlet end of the latent heat fin 430e is located, a heat exchange area has only a section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction D1 and a section in which the reference cross-sectional area is maintained. In the section from the third point E3 at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin 430e is located to a fourth point E4 located downstream of the third point E3, the reference cross-sectional area may gradually decrease along the reference direction D1, and in the section from the fourth point E4 to the fifth point E5, the reference cross-sectional area remains constant. Accordingly, the reference cross-sectional area at the fifth point E5 at which the outlet end of the latent heat fin 430e is located may be smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the third point E3 at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin 430e is located.

[0234] The housing 510e may be provided such that a first section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases from the outlet end of the sensible heat fin 330e to the inlet end of the latent heat fin 430e and a second section in which the reference cross-sectional area is maintained between the most upstream side and the outlet end of the latent heat fin 430e based on the reference direction D1 in the area where the latent heat fin 430e makes contact with the housing

510e are formed. The first section is a section from the second point **E2** adjacent to the outlet end of the sensible heat fin **330e** to the third point **E3** at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430e** is located, and the second section is a section from the fourth point **E4** to the fifth point **E5**. The area of the latent heat fin **430e** that makes contact with the inner surface of the housing **510e** may be provided such that the width of a portion corresponding to the second section remains constant based on the width of a fin defined in an orthogonal direction perpendicular to the reference direction **D1**.

[0235] Referring to the drawing, the latent heat exchange area may have a section from the second point **E2** to the fourth point **E4**, which is a section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1**, and a section from the first point **E1** to the second point **E2** and a section from the fourth point **E4** to the fifth point **E5**, which are sections in which the reference cross-sectional area remains constant.

[0236] FIG. **25** is a vertical sectional view of a heat exchanger unit according to a fourth modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0237] Referring to FIG. **25**, the heat exchanger unit according to the fourth modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure includes one row of sensible heat exchange pipes **320f** and one row of latent heat exchange pipes **420f**. The sensible heat exchange pipes **320f** include six straight portions, and the latent heat exchange pipes **420f** include six straight portions. However, the numbers of straight portions are not limited thereto.

[0238] A housing **510f** according to the fourth modified example of the third embodiment may also be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area at the most downstream side is smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the most upstream side based on a reference direction **D1**.

[0239] The housing **51** Of may be provided such that at least one section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1** is formed to allow combustion gas to flow at higher speed in a latent heat exchange area than in a sensible heat exchange area. Descriptions of effects obtained by the heat exchanger unit as the section in which the reference cross-sectional area decreases is disposed are replaced with the contents described above with reference to FIG. **20**.

[0240] The housing **51** Of may be provided such that the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases from the outlet end of a sensible heat fin **330f** to the inlet end of a latent heat fin **430f**. The housing **510f** may be formed such that the reference cross-sectional area of the section from a first point **F1** at which the outlet end of the sensible heat fin **330f** is located to a second point **F2** at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430f** is located gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1**. Accordingly, the reference cross-sectional area does not increase from the outlet end of the sensible heat fin **330f** to the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430f**.

[0241] The housing **510f** may be provided such that in the section from the second point **F2** at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430f** is located to the outlet end of the latent heat fin **430f**, a heat exchange area has only a section in which the reference cross-sectional area gradually decreases along the reference direction **D1** and a section in which the reference cross-sectional area is maintained. In the section from the second point **F2** at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430f** is located to a third point **F3** located downstream of the second point **F2**, the reference cross-sectional area may gradually decrease along the reference direction **D1**, and in the section from the third point **F3** to the outlet end of the latent heat fin **430f**, the reference cross-sectional area may remain constant. Accordingly, the reference cross-sectional area at the outlet end of the latent heat fin **430f** may be smaller than the reference cross-sectional area at the second point **F2** at which the inlet end of the latent heat fin **430f** is located.

[0242] Referring to the drawing, the latent heat fin **430f** according to the fourth modified example of the third embodiment of the present disclosure may include a pointed portion **4210f** at the most downstream-side end thereof. The pointed portion **4210f** is a portion in which the width in an orthogonal direction perpendicular to the reference direction **D1** decreases along the reference

direction **D1**, and a plurality of pointed portions **4210f** may be provided along the orthogonal direction. The pointed portion may have the above-described shape such that condensate formed on the latent heat fin **430f** by a phase change of the combustion gas is collected.

[0243] The descriptions of the configurations of the housings according to the modified examples of the third embodiment may be applied to other embodiments of the present disclosure and modified examples thereof.

[0244] FIG. **26** is a view illustrating the second general side plate **5114** of the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure together with flow passage caps included in the second flow passage cap plate **364**. FIG. **27** is a view illustrating the first general side plate **5113** of the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure together with flow passage caps included in the first flow passage cap plate **363**. FIG. **28** is a perspective view illustrating all the flow passages included in the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0245] Flow passages formed by the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**, the latent heat exchange pipe **420**, and the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** of the heat exchanger unit according to the third embodiment of the present disclosure will be described below with reference to FIGS. **26** to **28**. For a better understanding of areas through which the flow passages pass, the flow passage caps of the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** are not illustrated in FIG. **28** in a state in which the general side plates **5110**, the heat insulation side plates **5120**, and the fins of the heat exchanger unit are removed.

[0246] Referring to the other modified example of the first embodiment of FIG. **29**, FIG. **26** is view in which flow passage caps **3641**, **3642**, **3643**, **3644**, and **3645** of the second flow passage cap plate **364** are illustrated by dotted lines on a view of the second general side plate **5114**, the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**, the latent heat exchange pipe **420**, and sensible heat insulation pipes **3410** and **3420** of the third embodiment of the present disclosure that corresponds to a view of the heat exchanger unit when viewed from the second connection flow passage cap plate **72** of FIG. **29** along line H-H'. FIG. **27** is a view in which flow passage caps **3631**, **3632**, **3633**, and **3634** of the first flow passage cap plate **363** are illustrated by dotted lines on a view of the first general sensible heat side plate **5111**, the sensible heat exchange pipe **320**, the latent heat exchange pipe **420**, and the sensible heat insulation pipes **3410** and **3420** of the third embodiment of the present disclosure that corresponds to a view of the first main general side plate **5111**, into which the first connection flow passage cap plate **71** is inserted, when viewed along line G-G' of FIG. **29**.

[0247] The sensible heat straight portions may form a sensible flow passage through which the heating-water flows, and the latent heat straight portions **421** and **422** may form a latent heat flow passage through which the heating-water flows and that is connected to the sensible heat flow passage. The sensible heat flow passage may include a series flow passage in at least a partial section, and the latent heat flow passage may include a parallel flow passage in at least a partial section.

[0248] As described above, the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** may include the first flow passage cap plate **363** and the second flow passage cap plate **364**. The second flow passage cap plate **364** may have the first flow passage cap **3641**, the second flow passage cap **3642**, the third flow passage cap **3643**, the fourth flow passage cap **3644**, and the fifth flow passage cap **3645** formed thereon, and the first flow passage cap plate **363** may have the sixth flow passage cap **3631**, the seventh flow passage cap **3632**, the eighth flow passage cap **3633**, and the ninth flow passage cap **3634** formed thereon. The flow passage caps formed on the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** are formed in a convex shape toward the outside of the heat exchanger unit and are connected with the ends of the straight portions included in the sensible heat exchange pipe **320** or the ends of the straight portions **421** and **422** included in the latent heat exchange pipe **420** to allow the heating-water to flow inside. When the flow passage caps of the flow passage cap plates **363** and **364** cover the general side plates (**5110** of FIG. **17**), the heating-water flows in the space formed by

the general side plates and the flow passage caps.

[0249] The heating-water supply hole **3710** is formed in the first flow passage cap **3641** located at the most downstream side of the second flow passage cap plate **364** based on the reference direction **D1**. The heating-water is introduced into the heat exchanger unit through the heating-water supply hole **3710**. The introduced heating-water flows through the downstream straight portions **422**, each having one end connected to the first flow passage cap **3641**. Accordingly, the downstream straight portions **422** may form a parallel flow passage.

[0250] The heating-water reaches the sixth flow passage cap **3631**, to which an opposite end of each downstream straight portion **422** is connected, through the downstream straight portion **422**. The opposite end of the downstream straight portion **422** and one end of each upstream straight portion **421** are connected to the sixth flow passage cap **3631**. Accordingly, the heating-water is introduced into the upstream straight portions **421** from the sixth flow passage cap **3631** and flows along the upstream straight portions **421**. Accordingly, the upstream straight portions **421** may form a parallel flow passage.

[0251] An opposite end of each upstream straight portion **421** is connected to the second flow passage cap **3642**, and the heating-water flowing along the upstream straight portion **421** is delivered to the second flow passage cap **3642**. The second flow passage cap **3642** is connected with the first sensible heat insulation pipe **3410** and delivers the heating-water to the first sensible heat insulation pipe **3410**.

[0252] The heating-water moving along the first sensible heat insulation pipe **3410** reaches the seventh flow passage cap **3632** to which the first sensible heat insulation pipe **3410** is connected. A sensible heat flow passage in a zigzag form is formed along the sensible heat straight portions arranged in sequence from the seventh flow passage cap **3632** and connected in series, and the heating-water flows along the sensible heat flow passage from the seventh flow passage cap **3632** to the third flow passage cap **3643**, from the third flow passage cap **3643** to the eighth flow passage cap **3633**, from the eighth flow passage cap **3633** to the fourth flow passage cap **3644**, and from the fourth flow passage cap **3644** to the ninth flow passage cap **3634**. In a case where the sensible heat insulation pipes **3410** and **3420** are arranged as in the third embodiment of the present disclosure, the sensible heat flow passage may be implemented by connection of the straight portions included in the sensible heat insulation pipes **3410** and **3420** and the sensible heat exchange pipe **32**.

[0253] The ninth flow passage cap **3634** is also connected with the second sensible heat insulation pipe **3420**, and the heating-water flows along the second sensible heat insulation pipe **3420** and reaches the fifth flow passage cap **3645**. The fifth flow passage cap **3645** is connected with the heating-water discharge hole **3720**, and the heating-water delivered through the second sensible heat insulation pipe **3420** is discharged in a heated state through the heating-water discharge hole **3720**. The entire flow passage in which the heating-water is delivered between the downstream straight portions **422** and the upstream straight portions **421** connected with each other and the heating-water is delivered between the upstream straight portions **421** and the latent heat flow passage connected with each other is illustrated by arrows in FIG. **28**. The heating-water is heated and discharged while flowing along the entire flow passage.

[0254] Hereinabove, even though all of the components are coupled into one body or operate in a combined state in the description of the above-mentioned embodiments of the present disclosure, the present disclosure is not limited to these embodiments. That is, all of the components may operate in one or more selective combination within the range of the purpose of the present disclosure. It should be also understood that the terms of “include”, “comprise” or “have” in the specification are “open type” expressions just to say that the corresponding components exist and, unless specifically described to the contrary, do not exclude but may include additional components. Unless otherwise defined, all terms used herein, including technical and scientific terms, have the same meaning as those generally understood by those skilled in the art to which the present disclosure pertains. Such terms as those defined in a generally used dictionary are to be

interpreted as having meanings equal to the contextual meanings in the relevant field of art, and are not to be interpreted as having ideal or excessively formal meanings unless clearly defined as having such in the present application.

[0255] Hereinabove, although the present disclosure has been described with reference to exemplary embodiments and the accompanying drawings, the present disclosure is not limited thereto, but may be variously modified and altered by those skilled in the art to which the present disclosure pertains without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure claimed in the following claims. Therefore, the exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure are provided to explain the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, but not to limit them, so that the spirit and scope of the present disclosure is not limited by the embodiments. The scope of the present disclosure should be construed on the basis of the accompanying claims, and all the technical ideas within the scope equivalent to the claims should be included in the scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A heat exchanger unit comprising: a sensible heat exchanger including a sensible heat exchange pipe disposed in a sensible heat exchange area and configured to receive water and allow the water to flow through the sensible heat exchange pipe and a sensible heat fin disposed in the sensible heat exchange area and formed in a plate shape across the sensible heat exchange pipe such that the sensible heat exchange pipe passes through the sensible heat fin, the sensible heat exchange area being configured to receive sensible heat generated by a combustion reaction and heat the water; and a latent heat exchanger including a latent heat exchange pipe disposed in a latent heat exchange area and configured to receive the water and allow the water to flow through the latent heat exchange pipe, wherein the latent heat exchange area is located downstream of the sensible heat exchange area with respect to a reference direction that is a flow direction of combustion gas generated during the combustion reaction, the latent heat exchange area being configured to receive latent heat generated during a phase change of the combustion gas and heat the water, and a latent heat fin disposed in the latent heat exchange area and formed in a plate shape across the latent heat exchange pipe such that the latent heat exchange pipe passes through the latent heat fin; and a housing configured to surround the heat exchange areas to define the heat exchange areas therein, wherein when a cross-sectional area of the heat exchange area defined on a plane perpendicular to the reference direction is referred to as a reference cross-sectional area and the most upstream side and the most downstream side of the sensible heat exchanger or the latent heat exchanger with respect to the reference direction are referred to as an inlet end and an outlet end, and wherein the housing is provided such that a first section in which the reference cross-sectional area is reduced along the reference direction between an outlet end of the sensible heat fin and an inlet end of the latent heat fin and a second section in which the reference cross-sectional area is maintained between the inlet end of the latent heat fin and an outlet end of the latent heat fin are formed.
2. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the housing is provided such that at a predetermined point on the latent heat exchange area spaced apart from an outlet end of the latent heat exchange pipe in a direction opposite to the reference direction, the combustion gas flows at a speed increased by the section, in which the reference cross-sectional area is reduced, compared to a speed at an inlet end of the sensible heat exchange pipe.
3. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the housing is provided such that a reference cross-sectional area at the most downstream side is smaller than a reference cross-sectional area at the most upstream side with respect to the reference direction.
4. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the latent heat fin includes a plurality of upstream fins located at an upstream side with respect to the reference direction and a plurality of downstream fins located at a downstream side, wherein the outlet end of the sensible heat fin is located at an upstream side than inlet ends of the upstream fins with respect to the reference

direction, and wherein outlet ends of the upstream fins are located at an upstream side than inlet ends of the downstream fins with respect to the reference direction.

5. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the sensible heat fin includes a plurality of sensible heat fins, and the latent heat fin includes a plurality of latent heat fins, and wherein a distance by which two latent heat fins adjacent to each other among the plurality of latent heat fins are spaced apart from each other is longer than a distance by which two sensible heat fins adjacent to each other among the plurality of sensible heat fins are spaced apart from each other.

6. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the latent heat fin includes a plurality of upstream fins located at an upstream side with respect to the reference direction and a plurality of downstream fins located at a downstream side, and wherein a distance by which two downstream fins adjacent to each other among the plurality of downstream fins are spaced apart from each other is longer than a distance by which two upstream fins adjacent to each other among the plurality of upstream fins are spaced apart from each other.

7. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the sensible heat fin includes a plurality of sensible heat fins and the latent heat fin includes a plurality of latent heat fins, wherein the plurality of latent heat fins form at least one layer in which latent heat fins located in the same position with respect to the reference direction are disposed, and wherein the total number of latent heat fins disposed in a layer at the most downstream side with respect to the reference direction is smaller than the total number of sensible heat fins.

8. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the latent heat fin includes, on an end portion at the most downstream side of the latent heat fin with respect to the reference direction, a pointed portion in which a width in a direction perpendicular to the reference direction decreases along the reference direction to collect condensate formed by the phase change of the combustion gas.

9. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the sensible heat exchange pipe includes a plurality of sensible heat straight portions extending along a predetermined direction, the plurality of sensible heat straight portions being arranged to be spaced apart from each other along an orthogonal direction perpendicular to the predetermined direction and configured to form a sensible heat flow passage through which the water flows, and wherein the latent heat exchange pipe includes a plurality of latent heat straight portions extending along the predetermined direction, the plurality of latent heat straight portions being arranged to be spaced apart from each other along the orthogonal direction and configured to form a latent heat flow passage through which the water flows and that is fluidly connected to the sensible heat flow passage.

10. The heat exchanger unit of claim 9, wherein the sensible heat flow passage includes a series flow passage in at least a partial section, and wherein the latent heat flow passage includes a parallel flow passage in at least a partial section.

11. The heat exchanger unit of claim 9, wherein based on a cross-section depending on a plane perpendicular to the predetermined direction, a cross-sectional area of an interior space of the sensible heat straight portion is larger than a cross-sectional area of an interior space of the latent heat straight portion.

12. The heat exchanger unit of claim 9, wherein the latent heat straight portion includes an upstream straight portion located at an upstream side with respect to the reference direction and a downstream straight portion located at a downstream side, and wherein the section in which the reference cross-sectional area is reduced along the reference direction is additionally formed between an outlet end of the upstream straight portion and an inlet end of the downstream straight portion.

13. The heat exchanger unit of claim 12, wherein based on a cross-section depending on a plane perpendicular to the predetermined direction, a cross-sectional area of an interior space of the downstream straight portion is larger than or equal to a cross-sectional area of an interior space of the upstream straight portion.

14. The heat exchanger unit of claim 9, wherein based on a cross-section depending on a plane

perpendicular to the predetermined direction, an interior space of the sensible heat straight portion and an interior space of the latent heat straight portion have a shape of a long hole extending along the reference direction.

15. The heat exchanger unit of claim 14, wherein the long hole is formed such that a value obtained by dividing a length in the reference direction by a width in a direction perpendicular to the reference direction equals 2 or more.

16. The heat exchanger unit of claim 9, wherein an outlet of the sensible heat flow passage and an inlet of the latent heat flow passage are formed in one of side plates configured to form the housing.

17. The heat exchanger unit of claim 9, further comprising: a flow passage cap plate including, between the flow passage cap plate and one side plate among side plates configured to form the housing, a flow passage cap having a connection space surrounding an outlet of the latent heat flow passage and an inlet of the sensible heat flow passage to fluidly connect the outlet of the latent heat flow passage exposed outside the one side plate and the inlet of the sensible heat flow passage exposed outside the one side plate.

18. The heat exchanger unit of claim 9, wherein the number of sensible heat straight portions is smaller than the number of latent heat straight portions.

19. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the sensible heat exchange pipe includes a plurality of sensible heat straight portions extending along a predetermined direction, the plurality of sensible heat straight portions being arranged to be spaced apart from each other along an orthogonal direction perpendicular to the predetermined direction and configured to form a sensible heat flow passage through which the water flows, and wherein based on a cross-section depending on a plane perpendicular to the predetermined direction, an interior space of the sensible heat straight portion has a shape of a long hole extending along the reference direction.

20. The heat exchanger unit of claim 1, wherein the second section is formed from a point between the inlet end and the outlet end of the latent heat fin to the outlet end of the latent heat fin.
